

London Business School Event Toolkit for Student Clubs



Section quick links

1. Event necessity & definition

Making your mark in a busy events landscape

Events can provide an opportunity for ideas to spark, connections to flourish, and our community to come alive. From faculty discussions to global conferences, each gathering has the potential to shape careers, forge partnerships, and advance knowledge.

Yet with over 800 events hosted annually across London Business School, standing out requires more than good intentions. The most memorable events, those that truly move our community forward, share one quality: they exist for a compelling reason. They fill a genuine need, create meaningful value, and leave participants changed in some way.

This toolkit will help you join that tradition of excellence. But first, let's ensure an event is the right solution for your goals.

Ask yourself “Why?”

Before diving into logistics, challenge yourself: Is an event truly the best way to achieve your objectives?

Start with your goals and audience needs, then select the most effective engagement method. Often, alternative solutions to events deliver better results with fewer resources.

Match your need to the right solution

To share research findings or thought leadership

- **Consider:** Articles, blogs, LinkedIn posts, multimedia content
- **Why:** These formats reach your target audience through established channels without the overhead of event planning

To enable networking

- **Consider:** Leveraging existing gatherings, virtual meetups, or existing community platforms
- **Why:** More sustainable engagement than one-off events
- **Top tip:** Be mindful that the School has many established networking opportunities already, so look at what is happening across LBS

For updates and announcements

- **Consider:** Email bulletins, newsletter features, Teams/Hub posts, and short videos because these direct channels often achieve better engagement than events
- **Why:** Information reaches your audience when they're ready to receive it

When you're unsure of the best approach

If you're a student club, speak to the person who runs your channels.

If you don't know who to speak to, then you can attend one of the event planning drop-in sessions, which happen every Monday on Teams from 2-3pm - you simply book a 10 minute slot to ask any questions and get the support you need

- **[Event Planning Drop-in Session](#)**

If you cannot attend one of these session you can go to Editorial Planning (editorialplanning@london.edu), who can give you advice and help you identify the right channels and approach

The final strategic question

Before defaulting to an event, ask: "What specific value does bringing people together in person add that cannot be achieved another way?" If you struggle to answer, you've likely identified an opportunity for more effective communication.



Define your purpose with precision

If an event remains your chosen path, clarity of purpose becomes essential. Successful events start with a vision that everyone, organisers, speakers, and attendees, can rally behind.

Craft your vision

Your event vision should:

- Connect to LBS's mission of having a profound impact on the way the world does business and the way business impacts the world
- Articulate a clear benefit to participants
- Inspire action beyond the event itself

Set measurable objectives

Move beyond vague aspirations. What specifically will change because your event happened? Strong objectives are:

- **Specific:** Connect 50 MBA students with 10 sustainability-focused employers
- **Measurable:** Generate 20 collaborative research proposals
- **Time-bound:** Secure 5 corporate partnership leads within 30 days
- **Aligned:** Supports one or more of the LBS five foundations, department goals, or programme strategic priorities

Example KPIs for different event types

- [NUMBER]% of attendees attend another LBS event within [NUMBER] months
- [NUMBER]% of attendees use [SERVICE] within [NUMBER] months
- [NUMBER]% of registered attendees join their local alumni club
- [NUMBER] research collaborations initiated

Example vision:

Bring together Europe's sustainability pioneers to transform how businesses measure and communicate their environmental impact, creating a new standard for corporate transparency.



Your post-event commitments

To ensure LBS events have value and to continuously improve and evolve, we require insightful data. Your commitment to proceeding with an event signifies an agreement to:

- **Share core data:** Attendance figures, engagement metrics, budget reconciliation
- **Provide detailed evaluation:** What worked, what didn't, recommendations for future
- **Measure real impact:** Track outcomes against your stated objectives
- **Document learnings:** Create handover materials for future organisers

Why does the School require this data? This information will help you and future organisers make better decisions.

Remember: Setting clear, achievable objectives isn't just administrative - it's the foundation of a successful event. Plan your measurement approach before the event, not after. Then, before proceeding, honestly assess whether your event can deliver on its promises.

Ask yourself:

- Are these objectives realistic given our resources and constraints?
- Can we genuinely measure success against these goals?
- If we can't confidently meet these objectives, should we be running this event at all?

Too often, event organisers set ambitious goals only to realise post-event that they were never truly achievable. Save yourself and your attendees the disappointment. If you can't see a clear path to meeting your stated objectives, it is time to reconsider whether an event is the right solution.

Assess your return on investment

Every event requires an investment of time, money, and opportunity cost. Before proceeding, evaluate whether the expected returns justify these resources.

Calculate true costs

- **Direct costs:** Venue, catering, technology, marketing
- **Indirect costs:** Staff time, volunteer hours, participant time away from other activities
- **Opportunity costs:** What else could these resources achieve? For example, while LBS venues are free for internal use, they have commercial value (e.g. Nuffield Hall can generate tens of thousands per day if hired externally)

Measure potential returns

- **Immediate outcomes:** Registrations, attendance, engagement metrics
- **Medium-term impact:** New relationships, knowledge application, behaviour change
- **Long-term value:** Enhanced reputation, sustained partnerships

Use our decision-making framework

If you've not run an LBS event before, here is a framework that other Event Organisers have found useful. You can work through these questions systematically. If you struggle to provide compelling answers, it may signal that alternatives would better serve your goals.

1. Strategic alignment

- How does this event advance [LBS's five foundations](#)?
 - Striving for excellence
 - Delivering impact
 - Global reach
 - Leveraging agility
 - Enhancing our community
- Which School or programme priority does it directly support?
- What happens if this event doesn't occur?

2. Unique value

- What will attendees gain that they cannot get elsewhere?
- Why must this be an event rather than another format?
- How is this different from similar events already planned?

3. Audience clarity

- Who specifically needs to be in the room?
- Why will they choose to attend?
- What will they do differently afterwards?

4. Resource readiness

- Do you have committed funding secured?
- Is the team prepared for the full scope of work?
- Can you deliver excellence within any identified constraints?

5. Success metrics

- How will you measure success beyond attendance?
- What data will you collect to prove impact?
- Who needs to see evidence of success?



Answer the essential planning questions

Why?

- Purpose: *What change are you trying to create?*
- Problem: *What challenge does this event address?*
- Promise: *What will participants gain?*

Who?

- Primary audience: *Who must attend for success?*
- Secondary audiences: *Who else could benefit?*
- **Key stakeholders:** *Who has an interest in the outcomes?*
- Speaker criteria: *What expertise, profile or knowledge is essential?*

To help with the 'who', remember to consider all School audiences:

1. Advancement: *Alumni, donors and prospective donors*
2. Internal: *Current students, staff, faculty, Governing Body*
3. Prospective students: *Executive Education and Degree Education*
4. External: *Press, public, policy makers, academics and students from other institutions, corporate partners*
5. *Research Institutes and Centres: Their specific networks and contacts*

Important: Before approaching any audience group, consult with the relevant 'audience owner' to ensure alignment with other communications and to explore using their established channels.

Tip: Consider the audience perspective. Who do they expect to see? Who do they want to network with?

What?

- **Format:** Conference, workshop, networking, ceremony?
- **Content:** What knowledge or experiences will you share or gain?
- **Atmosphere:** Professional, celebratory, collaborative?
- **Outcomes:** What will exist or happen after the event ends?

When?

- **Date selection:** Consider the academic calendar, holidays, and competing events
- **Duration:** Minimum time needed for impact
- **Timing:** Time of day, day of week for maximum attendance

Check for clashes

- **Event master list:** Access this regularly updated document to see a list of the key events happening across LBS - [event master list](#)
- **Campus Groups:** Review student-led events at https://clubs.london.edu/home_login





Moving forward

If you've worked through this section and remain convinced an event is the right approach, you're ready to proceed with planning. The following sections will guide you through bringing your vision to life.

If you've decided that alternative solutions might better serve your goals, please contact Editorial Planning at to explore how to amplify your message through existing channels.

editorialplanning@london.edu

Remember:

At LBS, we measure success not by how many events we host, but by the lasting impact we create. Make yours count.



2. Event strategy & objectives

Transform vision into action

You've determined an event is necessary. You've articulated why bringing people together creates unique value. Now comes the strategic work. This section will help you build a robust framework that guides every decision from speaker selection to catering choices.

The SMART framework in practice

Specific - Eliminate ambiguity

- **Weak:** Enhance alumni engagement
- **Strong:** Connect 80 finance alumni with 15 fintech founders for partnership discussions

Measurable - Define what success looks like

- **Weak:** Good attendance
- **Strong:** 120 registrations, 100 attendees, 85% stay for the entire programme

Achievable - Balance ambition with reality

- **Consider:** Budget, timeline, team capacity, competing events, audience availability
- **Test:** Can you identify the specific actions needed to reach this goal? And is the space you have requested the right space for the numbers you will realistically achieve? Don't book a large space 'just in case' if you only expect small numbers.
- **Be brutally honest:** if you can't see a clear path to achieving your objectives with the resources available, reconsider whether an event is the right approach. Too often, organisers set ambitious goals only to realise post-event that they were never achievable. It's better to pivot early than disappoint attendees and waste resources.

Relevant - Does your event advance one or more of LBS's five foundations?

1. Striving for excellence
2. Delivering impact
3. Global reach
4. Leveraging agility
5. Enhancing our community

Time-bound - Create accountability

- Set deadlines for what you want to achieve and when
- Include milestone markers, for example, "20% of the target achieved by week 4 of promotion"



Objective-setting workshop

Work through these prompts with your team:

- 1. **Complete this sentence:** This event will be successful if, three months later...
- 2. **List three specific changes** you expect to see in attendee behaviour
- 3. **Identify one metric** that would make your Associate Dean/director/SA president proud
- 4. **Name the strategic priority** this directly supports
- 5. **Set a date** by which you'll measure success

The 80/20 principle

Focus on the 20% of your audience that will drive 80% of your success:

- Who are your must-have attendees? These can be specific people (e.g. targeted VIPs) and/or types of people, such as specific student groups.
- What would make this unmissable for them?
- How can you design the experience around their needs?

Top tip: It often helps to create personas of your must-have attendees to understand their wants, needs and expectations.

Define and understand your target audience

You've identified who could attend. Now determine who must attend for success and what will make them choose your event over competing priorities.

Create audience personas

Move beyond demographics to psychographics. For each key audience segment, document the following:

Professional content	Engagement drivers	Value requirements
• Current role and responsibilities • Career stage and aspirations • Key challenges they face • Time pressures and constraints	• What content excites them? • Which format(s) do they prefer? • When are they available? • Who influences their decisions?	• What return on time investment do they need? • What would make them recommend this to peers? • What would make them prioritise this over other options?

Audience journey mapping

Trace your priority audience's path:

- 1. **Awareness:** How will they first hear about this?
- 2. **Interest:** What will make them want to learn more?
- 3. **Decision:** What tips them from "maybe" to "yes"?
- 4. **Experience:** What will exceed their expectations?
- 5. **Advocacy:** What will make them promote this to others and come back to other LBS events?



Develop KPIs that matter

Building on the examples in section 1, here's how to create a comprehensive measurement framework:

The KPI hierarchy

Level 1: Activity metrics (necessary but not sufficient)

- Registration numbers
- Attendance rate
- Social media impressions
- Email open rates

Level 2: Engagement metrics (showing active participation)

- Session attendance throughout the event (if a conference)
- Questions asked during Q&A
- Networking participation rates
- Content interaction (downloads, shares, etc.)

Level 3: Impact metrics (proving value creation)

- Behaviour change commitments, such as attendance at future events
- New connections formed with follow-up
- Business opportunities identified

Level 4: Strategic metrics (demonstrating organisational value)

- Contribution to the School's five foundations and reputation
- Revenue or partnership generation
- Media coverage quality and reach
- Long-term relationship development

Create your KPI dashboard

For each objective, identify:

- **Leading indicator:** What will predict success? (registrations, speaker confirmations)
- **Lagging indicator:** What will prove success? (partnerships formed, research cited)
- **Data source:** How will you capture this?
- **Measurement timing:** When will you check?
- **Success threshold:** What number means "we did it"?



Select the optimal event format

Your format should deliver your objectives within your constraints. Consider each option carefully:

Conference/Summit

- **Best for:** Thought leadership, major announcements, industry positioning
- **Audience:** 100+ diverse stakeholders
- **Success factors:** High-profile speakers, multiple perspectives, media appeal
- **Lead time recommendation:** 12+ months
- **Budget implications:** High (£15K-100K+)

Workshop/Masterclass

- **Best for:** Skill development, deep learning, behaviour change
- **Audience:** 15-40 committed participants
- **Success factors:** Interactive exercises, practical takeaways, expert facilitation
- **Lead time recommendation:** At least 3-4 months
- **Budget implications:** Medium (£3K-20K)

Networking reception

- **Best for:** Relationship building, community strengthening, celebration
- **Audience:** 50-200 with common interests
- **Success factors:** Facilitating connections, comfortable environment, clear purpose
- **Lead time recommendation:** At least 3-4 months
- **Budget implications:** Medium (£3K-20K)

Panel discussion

- **Best for:** Exploring debates, showcasing expertise, addressing controversies
- **Audience:** 40-150 seeking diverse viewpoints
- **Success factors:** Dynamic moderation, genuine disagreement, audience Q&A
- **Lead time recommendation:** At least 3-4 months
- **Budget implications:** Low-Medium (£1K-10K)

Fireside chat

- **Best for:** Intimate insights, personal stories, leadership lessons
- **Audience:** 30-100 seeking inspiration
- **Success factors:** Compelling speaker, skilled interviewer, relaxed atmosphere
- **Lead time recommendation:** At least 3-4 months
- **Budget implications:** Low-Medium (£1K-10K)

Hybrid experience

- **Best for:** Maximising reach, including global audiences
- **Audience:** Core in-person plus extended virtual
- **Success factors:** Technical excellence, equal participation, engaging both audiences
- **Lead time recommendation:** 6+ months
- **Budget implications:** High (add 40-60% to base format cost)

Additional challenges for hybrid events:

- **Critical consideration:** Delivering an experience beyond a basic Teams meeting needs extra budget. A quality hybrid event requires multiple cameras, camera operators, video mixing equipment, and technical staff.
- **Coordination complexity:** The extra moving parts present a significantly higher risk and a bigger investment of your time
- **Ask yourself:** Can you deliver an equally engaging experience for in-person and virtual audiences? If not, choose one format and excel at it

The format checklist

Before finalising, confirm your chosen format:

- ☐ Matches your primary objective
- ☐ Suits your audience preferences
- ☐ Works within budget and resource constraints
- ☐ Leverages available spaces effectively
- ☐ Differentiates from similar events
- ☐ Creates desired atmosphere



Create a compelling event proposition

Your event competes for attention with countless alternatives. At London Business School alone, we run over 800 events. Therefore, you need to craft a proposition that makes attendance feel essential, not optional.

The value proposition

For your audience, articulate:

Pain relievers	Gain creators	Unique differentiators
• Which frustrations does this event address? • What barriers to success does it remove? • Which knowledge gaps does it fill?	• What new capabilities will attendees develop? • Which connections will accelerate their goals? • What exclusive insights will they receive?	• What can't they get anywhere else? • Why is this timing critical? • What makes your speakers/content unique?

Write your elevator pitch

Complete this framework:

Join us for [event name], the only [format] that brings together [unique audience mix] to [compelling outcome]. Unlike [common alternative], we'll [key differentiator], enabling you to [specific benefit].

Test it: Would this make someone cancel another commitment to attend?

The FOMO factor

Create constructive fear of missing out (FOMO):

- Limited capacity that creates exclusivity
- One-time-only speakers or announcements
- First access to research or resources
- Unique networking combinations
- Time-sensitive opportunities



Map and engage your stakeholders

Of course, success requires more than attendees. Identify everyone with an interest in or influence on your event's outcome.

Stakeholder mapping matrix

Plot each stakeholder on two axes:

- **Influence:** How much can they impact success?
- **Interest:** How much do they care about outcomes?

High influence, high interest → Manage closely

- Regular updates and input opportunities
- Early involvement in key decisions
- Recognition of contribution

High influence, low interest → Keep satisfied

- Executive summaries only
- Focus on what matters to them
- Minimal time requirements

Low influence, high interest → Keep informed

- Regular updates through efficient channels
- Opportunities to contribute within scope
- Clear communication of decisions

Low influence, low interest → Monitor

- General updates only
- Standard communications

Key stakeholder categories

Internal champions

- Who can unlock resources or remove barriers?
- Whose endorsement carries weight?
- Who has relationships with key speakers?

Content contributors

- Faculty with relevant expertise
- Alumni with compelling stories
- Industry partners with fresh perspectives

Operational enablers

- Space Management (likely already engaged if you're here)
- Campus Service teams that understand your vision
- Technology partners for digital elements

Audience gatekeepers

- Programme offices for student audiences
- Alumni Engagement for alumni contacts - ADVstakeholders@london.edu
- Executive Education for corporate partners or executive participants

Amplifiers

- Your network is your first promotional channel - ask your core event team and colleagues to spread the message
- Editorial Planning for strategic events (we have a whole section on this later in the toolkit)
- Industry media contacts

Stakeholder engagement plan

For each key stakeholder:

1. Define their 'win' from your event
2. Identify what you need from them, ideally with a deadline
3. Determine engagement frequency
4. Assign relationship owner
5. Plan recognition approach

Your strategic framework

By completing this section, you've built:

- ❑ Objectives that drive every decision
- ❑ Deep audience understanding that shapes design
- ❑ KPIs that prove real value
- ❑ A format that delivers on promise
- ❑ A proposition that compels attendance
- ❑ A stakeholder map that enables success

With this foundation, you're ready to transform strategy into reality. The following sections of this toolkit will guide you through making it happen.

Remember: Great events don't happen by accident. They're the result of strategic thinking translated into meticulous planning. You've done the thinking. Now let's start building.

Please note: When you come to organising your first (or next) LBS event, you will have access to templates and documents to help you capture your ideas and requirements. These include the Space Request Form and Event Information Sheet.



3. Project management & timelines

Create your path to success

Great events emerge from teams working together to achieve a shared goal.

The timelines and structures in this section are guidelines, not rules. We recognise that flagship events often need to be planned 12+ months in advance, while other opportunities, such as a suddenly available high-profile speaker or a breaking industry development, demand agility. Whether you have a year or weeks, these principles adapt to your reality.





Build your team

Design your team based on the events' scale and complexity. Not every role needs a dedicated person. Smaller events might have one person wearing multiple hats. What matters is that every responsibility has a clear owner.

Event Organiser

The single point of accountability for event success - this is one named person whom all Campus Services teams can contact.

- Owns timeline, budget responsibilities and final decisions
- Chairs internal team meetings and manages stakeholder communications
- Primary liaison with Campus Services teams

Critical points:

- The Event Organiser must be the contact for the Space Request Form submission
- Responsible for completing the Event Information Sheet Required to attend the Key Events Meeting, if your event has been identified as a Key Event (more on this later)
- Coordinates all service requirements: catering, AV, security, facilities, etc.

Deputy Event Organiser

In addition to the main Event Organiser, we strongly recommend you appoint a Deputy Event Organiser who can step in when needed (e.g. to cover because of illness, leave, or urgent matters that the Event Organiser cannot control).

- Fully briefed on all event details and decisions
- Included in key communications and has access to all event documents
- Can attend meetings and make decisions in the lead's absence



Key areas to consider for your event team

Here are some roles and responsibilities you may want to consider, particularly for large scale or high-profile events.

Content & Programme

- What's the narrative arc of your event?
- Who manages speaker relationships and briefings?
- How will you ensure content aligns with objectives?
- What's your plan B if a speaker cancels?

Marketing & Attendee Experience

- How will you reach your target audience?
- Who manages the registration process?
- What journey will attendees experience from invitation to follow-up?
- How will you track and boost attendance?

Budget & Resources

- Who tracks spending against the budget?
- How will you manage sponsor relationships (if applicable)?
- Who processes invoices and handles financial reconciliation?
- What cost-saving opportunities exist?
- Who manages procurement processes and engaging external suppliers?

Operations & Logistics

- Who coordinates with LBS Campus Services teams?
- How will you manage the on-the-day setup and flow?
- Who handles VIP requirements and accessibility needs?
- What's your contingency plan for emergencies?

Building an effective event team

Whether you're staff or student, consider these factors when assembling your team:

Knowledge transfer: Document everything. Future event organisers need your insights, especially for recurring annual events.

Skills balance: Match roles to personal strengths while providing growth opportunities.

Workload planning: Consider academic calendars, work commitments, holidays, and other major deadlines when assigning responsibilities.

Diverse perspectives: Draw on different backgrounds, experiences, and viewpoints to create more inclusive, innovative events.

Succession planning: Identify and brief potential successors early, particularly important for student-led events with annual turnover.

Make roles crystal clear

However you decide to structure your core event team, ensure everyone knows:

- **What** they're responsible for delivering
- **Who** they need to coordinate with
- **When** their deliverables are due

The clarity test:

Can any team member explain their role and top three priorities in 30 seconds? If yes, you're set. If no, keep refining.

Top tip on working together:

Use whatever framework helps your team succeed. Some teams love spreadsheets. Others prefer visual boards. Many thrive with simple WhatsApp groups. The best system is the one your team actually uses.



Master your timeline

Your timeline is your roadmap to success. Build it backwards from your event date, allowing buffer time for the inevitable surprises. Being ambitious and optimistic is great, but the planning fallacy is real. Events almost always take longer to plan than expected. Build in buffer time from the start - if you think something will take two weeks, plan for three. This is especially true when coordinating with multiple stakeholders or external suppliers.

Timeline principles

- **Start with non-negotiable deadlines and work backwards:** There are some fixed activities that cannot move such as:
 - Catering orders (where catering is required)
 - Attending the Key Events Meeting (for events identified as Key Events)
 - Security clearance
- **Critical path identification:** Which tasks must happen in sequence? Which can run in parallel? Focus your energy on sequential bottlenecks that could delay everything else.
- **Buffer building:** Add 20% extra time for tasks involving external parties or busy stakeholders. Create contingency plans for critical dependencies
- **Milestone visibility:** Share key dates with all stakeholders early and often.
- **The 48-hour rule:** Make no major changes within 48 hours of the event unless it is absolutely critical.

For comprehensive suggestions of key milestones and suggested timings, see the [event master list](#). This will help you plan when to:

- Book spaces on campus and speakers
- Launch registration and marketing
- Submit required forms and security clearances
- Finalise logistics and suppliers



Anticipate challenges with a pre-mortem

Before problems arise, imagine they already have. The pre-mortem technique (imagining failure before it happens) helps identify risks while you can still prevent them.

Conduct your pre-mortem session

Gather your core team during your early planning stages:

1. **Set the scene:** "Imagine it's the day after our event, and it was a disaster. What went wrong?"
2. **Identifying potential risks:** Each person writes potential failure points (10 minutes)
3. **Share scenarios:** Go round-robin without judgment
4. **Categorise risks:**
 - High probability, high impact
→ Prevent at all costs
 - High probability, low impact
→ Mitigate efficiently
 - Low probability, high impact
→ Create contingency plans
 - Low probability, low impact
→ Accept and monitor

Your risk register

It is often a good idea to create a living document that tracks, especially for larger scales event:

- Risk description
- Likelihood (1-5)
- Impact (1-5)
- Risk score (Likelihood × Impact)
- Mitigation actions
- Contingency plans
- Risk owner
- Review date

Once you have this document, you can use it for future events.

London Business School also has a **Risk Assessment Matrix Audit form** which you should complete for large scale events or events where you have a majority of external delegates.

Run event planning meetings that matter

Your meetings set the tone for your entire event. Make them count.

Meeting rhythm

Regular team meetings

- Progress against the timeline and deliverables
- Blockers and solutions
- Key decisions needed
- Actions for the coming week(s)

Stakeholder updates (bi-weekly or monthly)

- High-level progress
- Budget status
- Risk alerts
- Support needed

Supplier check-ins (as needed)

- Specific requirements
- Timeline alignment
- Issue resolution



Navigate the LBS busy events schedule

Your event means nothing if your audience can't attend. Annually, LBS hosts more than 800 events, in addition to regular programme activities, public and religious holidays, significant cultural events, and other considerations that can all impact attendance at your event.

Date selection strategy

Check before you book

The master events calendar is your essential first stop:

Events calendar: Access the live [event master list](#). This comprehensive spreadsheet is updated regularly with all confirmed events across LBS, including:

- Key events and flagship programmes
- Student club activities
- Academic dates and exam periods
- External bookings and conferences

Campus Groups: Review student-led events at clubs.london.edu/events to:

- Avoid scheduling conflicts with major club events
- Identify collaboration opportunities
- Understand the student event landscape

Space Management support: Contact space@london.edu if you need help understanding what's already scheduled or advice on optimal timing for your event. They can provide insights on:

- Historically busy periods
- Venue availability patterns
- Potential clash considerations

Your project management toolkit

By now, you have:

- ❑ A team with clear roles (defined your way)
- ❑ A realistic timeline adapted to your planning horizon
- ❑ Risks identified and mitigated
- ❑ Meeting rhythms that work for your team
- ❑ A clash-free date selection

These foundations free you to focus on what matters... creating an extraordinary experience that advances LBS's mission and leaves participants transformed.

Remember: Project management isn't about following rigid templates - it's about creating clarity and momentum using whatever methods resonate with your team. Trust your judgment, adapt these guidelines to your context, and focus on outcomes.



4. Budget planning & sponsorship

Start with financial clarity

Your budget isn't just numbers on a spreadsheet. It's the foundation that determines whether your event soars or struggles. Poor financial planning leads to last-minute compromises, stressed teams, and damaged reputations. Get budgeting right, and everything else becomes possible.

Define your financial objectives

Before opening any spreadsheet, be clear about your financial goals:

- **Revenue-generating:** Event must be profitable to fund future activities
- **Break-even:** Cover all costs through tickets and sponsorship
- **Investment:** Accept a loss for strategic value (brand building, community engagement)
- **Subsidised:** Partial cost recovery to ensure accessibility

Your objective drives every subsequent decision from ticket pricing to sponsorship targets.

Build a comprehensive budget

Understand your cost structure

Fixed costs (same regardless of attendance):

- Venue hire
- Any speaker associated costs, for example travel if required
- AV equipment base package
- Design and production
- Marketing materials
- Insurance (if required)

Variable costs (scale with attendees):

- Catering per person
- Welcome packs/giveaways
- Additional AV for larger audiences
- Extra security or staff
- Registration materials
- Giveaways



The hidden costs that catch you out

Never forget to include:

- **VAT on everything:** Always show costs inclusive of VAT. If unsure whether a quote includes VAT, ask immediately
- **Setup/breakdown costs:** Consider any additional charges that may be incurred pre and post event
- **Security costs:** You are expected to cover security costs, and for larger events, or events with VIP guests, the School often has to bring in extra security staff
- **Audio-Visual (AV):** If you need specialist equipment or plan to do a hybrid event, you will need to cover the additional costs required
- **Cancellation insurance:** For high-stakes events
- **Speaker hospitality:** Transport, accommodation, meals (if agreed)
- **Accessibility provisions:** British Sign Language (BSL) interpreters, hearing loops
- **Photography/videography:** Often forgotten until it's too late
- **Post-event costs:** Thank you gifts, follow-up materials

Build your budget framework

1. **List every possible expense** - Better to remove items than discover them later
2. **Get written quotes** - Verbal estimates often prove optimistic, so always ask for a quote in writing
3. **Check all quotes include VAT** - This 20% surprise breaks budgets
4. **Categorise as must-have vs nice-to-have**

The contingency imperative

Unexpected costs are not unexpected. They're inevitable. To cover these costs, you must build contingency into your budget.

- **General guidance for events:** Allocate 10% contingency minimum
- **For first-time events:** Allocate 15-20% contingency
- **For complex events (e.g. large capacity, hybrid, or events over multiple days) or outdoor events:** Allocate 20-25% contingency

Common contingency needs:

- Last-minute dietary requirements
- Weather-related additions
- Speaker requirement changes
- Technical failures requiring replacements
- Higher attendance than expected

Manage your budget actively

Track like a professional

- Weekly reviews during planning: Compare committed spend against budget
- Detailed monitoring near event: Watch variable costs as numbers firm up
- Post-event reconciliation: Aim to do this within 10 working days of your event

The reconciliation checklist

- ☐ All supplier invoices received and checked
- ☐ Final catering charges (consumption-based) confirmed
- ☐ Staff/volunteer expenses submitted
- ☐ Sponsor invoices sent (if applicable)
- ☐ Ticket revenue reconciled
- ☐ Budget vs actual report completed
- ☐ Lessons learned documented for next year



Identify and secure funding for Student Clubs

Funding sources for student events

1. Coin Vote allocation

- The SA allocates money to clubs based on the number of 'coins' that a club collects in the schoolwide vote
- Plan events to demonstrate value for next year's vote

2. Membership/Subscription and ticket sales

- Set prices that reflect value while ensuring accessibility
- Consider tiered pricing for different audiences

3. Sponsorship

4. SA Club Support Fund

- Available for clubs with a balance under £5,000
- Apply for up to £1,000 for specific initiatives
- [Contact SA Treasury with a clear proposal](#)

5. Inter-club collaboration

- Pool resources for joint events
- Share costs for high-profile speakers

Student Association Club Treasurer Portal

You can find more information, including a sponsorship agreement template, on the [SA Club Portal](#).

Master the sponsorship game - advice for Student Clubs

Start with a strategy

Successful sponsorship is about creating partnerships where everyone wins.

Assign a dedicated sponsorship lead:

This role requires persistence, professionalism, and relationship-building skills over months.

Timing is everything:

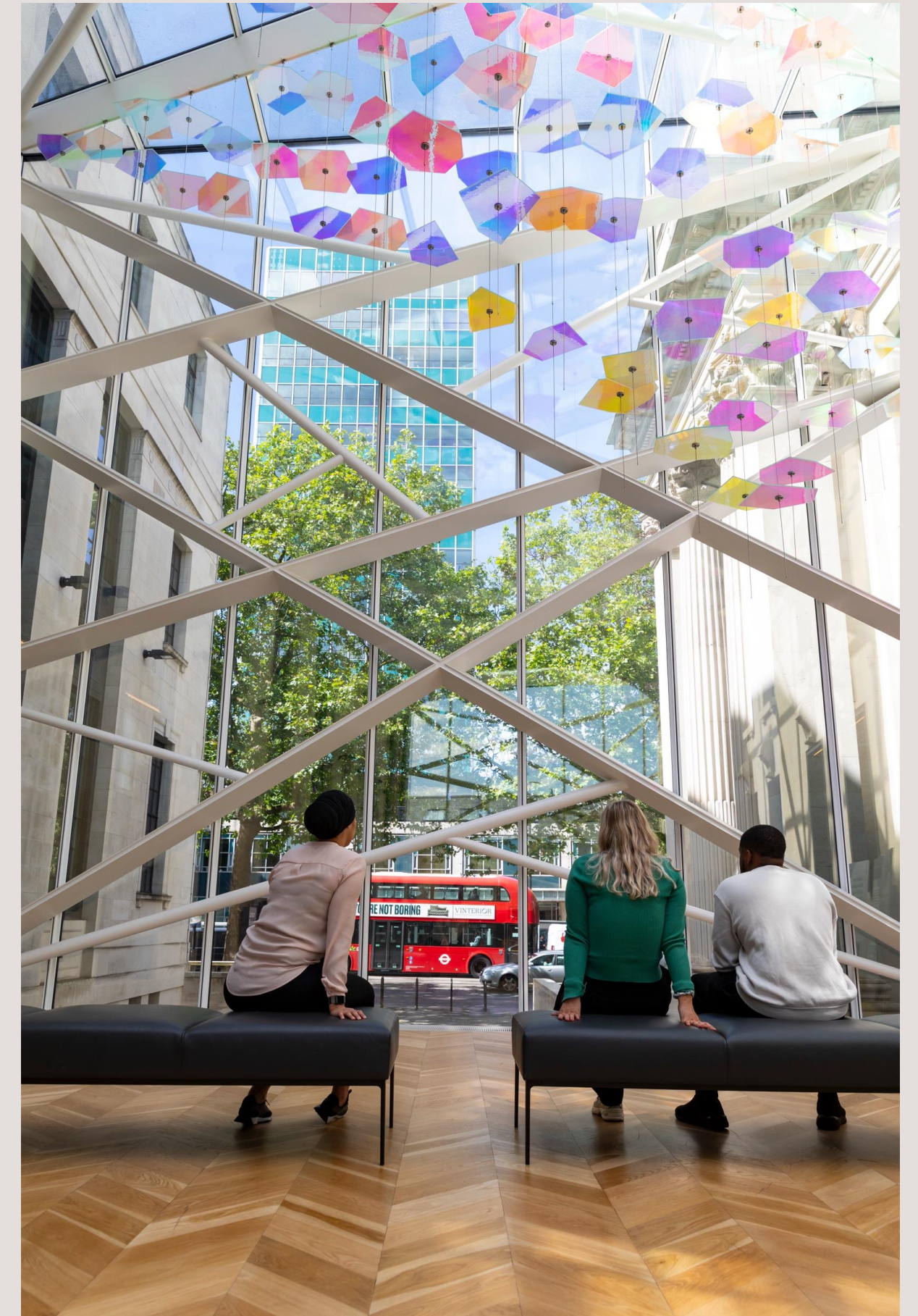
- Many companies set sponsorship budgets in April-August for the following year
- Others have funds available at the financial year-end (December/March)
- Start conversations as early as possible before your event

Build your sponsorship proposition

Answer the sponsor's key question:

"What's in it for us?"

- Your value proposition might include:
- Access to specific talent pools for recruitment
- Brand visibility to target demographics
- Thought leadership positioning
- Corporate social responsibility objectives
- Employee engagement opportunities
- Client entertainment possibilities



Create compelling packages

Title Sponsor

- Event naming rights
- Keynote speaking opportunity
- Prime exhibition space
- Logo on all materials
- Exclusive recruitment/networking session
- 10+ event tickets

Gold Sponsor

- Panel participation
- Exhibition space
- Logo on marketing materials
- Pre-event attendee list (GDPR compliant)
- 5-8 event tickets

Silver Sponsor

- Exhibition table
- Logo on event website
- Social media recognition
- 2-4 event tickets

Bronze Sponsor

- Logo on event website
- Programme advertisement
- 1-2 event tickets

Think beyond cash

In-kind sponsorship options:

- Venue provision
- Catering services
- Technology/AV equipment
- Prize donations
- Professional services (design, marketing)
- Speaker provision

Navigate VAT on sponsorship

Please note that there is no VAT charged when:

- Pure donation with no benefits
- Sponsor receives only an acknowledgement

VAT charged (20%) when the sponsor receives:

- Tickets (free or discounted)
- Exhibition space
- Speaking opportunities
- Promotional benefits
- Attendee data (ensure GDPR compliance)

Always clarify VAT treatment when creating packages. Include VAT in sponsor pricing if benefits trigger VAT.

The sponsorship process

1. **Contact SA sponsorship:**
Please email sasponsorship@london.edu
2. **Attended the required training:**
The SA offers Finance training which covers the process in full from creating detailed written agreements, contracts, invoicing and payment terms

Critical: Clubs cannot enter into contracts directly. All agreements must go through SA to protect officers from personal liability.



Navigate financial processes

Key financial rules:

1. Events must have an approved finance code 2 weeks before the event
2. Maintain club balance >£0 (to transact) and <£20,000 (for Coin Vote eligibility)
3. ExCo-only socials limited to 10% of annual spend
4. Maximum £45/head within any expense reimbursement
5. Cannot award cash prizes from club funds
6. Cannot donate club funds to charities

Approval thresholds:

- Expense reimbursements >£1,000: Need SA Senior Treasurer pre-approval
- Supplier invoices >£8,000: Need SA Senior Treasurer pre-approval
- Any payments to LBS-related parties (students, faculty, staff, recent alumni): Need pre-approval

Budget approval: Through the club treasurer and SA Finance

Expense approval: Follow Infor XM system requirements

Payment processing:

- Supplier invoices through the SA payment system
- Reimbursements via expense claim form (with itemised receipts)
- Allow a minimum of 2 weeks for processing

Price tickets strategically

The pricing psychology

- **Too high:** Low attendance, perception of elitism
- **Too low:** Perceived lack of value, budget shortfalls
- **Just right:** Reflects value, ensures accessibility, meets objectives

Research your price point

Benchmark against:

- Similar events at LBS
- Competitor events in London
- Your audience's budget reality
- Historical pricing (if applicable)

Ticket structure options

Standard pricing:

- Student rate (typically 50-70% discount)
- Alumni rate (slightly discounted)
- External rate (full price)

Dynamic pricing:

- Super early bird (3+ months out): Offer an attractive discount for early sign-ups
- Early bird (6-8 weeks): Offer a smaller discount to encourage sign-ups
- Standard pricing: Full price

Value-added option ideas:

- VIP tickets with speaker meet-and-greet
- Table bookings with premium placement
- Package deals with accommodation
- Group discounts for 5+ tickets

Key contacts & templates:

- SA Treasury:
safinance@london.edu
(or use Teams)
- SA Sponsorship:
sasponsorship@london.edu
- [Event budget template](#)

Remember:

Financial excellence isn't about penny-pinching. It's about maximising impact within resources. Every pound saved through smart planning is a pound available for creating memorable experiences.



5. Venue & logistics planning

Transform your vision into reality

The right space sets the stage for success. Whether you're hosting an intimate workshop or a flagship conference, this section guides you through securing the perfect venue and coordinating the logistics that bring your event to life.

At London Business School, our Space Management team are your partners in finding the ideal solution. Tell them what you need, and they'll match your requirements to the perfect space. They know every corner of campus and understand how different venues work for different event types.

Request space based on your needs

Our approach puts your event requirements first, ensuring you get a venue that works for your objectives. To book a space, please download the **Space Request Form**. You should include as much detail as possible at this stage to ensure you are allocated a space appropriate to your needs and event objectives.

Please note that all LBS events are designated as 18 and over. When completing your Space Request Form, you must confirm that your event complies with this policy. If there are exceptional circumstances where someone under 18 needs to attend, approval is required and a risk assessment will need to be completed, and additional security may be required at the Event Organiser's cost.

What happens next

1. Submit your completed Space Request Form to space@london.edu
2. Space Management reviews suitability and availability
3. In some cases, your event will be reviewed by the School's Events Oversight Group, and you may need to complete a business case document
4. Space Management will recommend the best space(s) for your needs
5. You'll receive a booking confirmation email with your Event ID as soon as possible
6. If your event has been identified as a Key Event, you will be notified by email and invited to a Key Events Meeting (more on this later)

Pro tips: Be flexible with dates where possible. If Thursday is preferred but Wednesday works too, mention both. This approach often yields better options and faster confirmations.

Also, be mindful of additional requirements such as storage space, green rooms, supplier rooms, organiser rooms, and interview rooms that you may require.



Standard event process verses the 'Key Events' process

For most events, once your event space is confirmed, you should coordinate directly with the relevant Campus Services teams via email or Teams.

Everybody must adhere to the event security process, which includes providing speaker details and guest list information to Security, and on-campus event catering must be arranged through our Catering team (further details on Security and Catering process are available later in the toolkit).

Your space booking confirmation email will include a list of key services and their contact details. It is your responsibility to reach out to these services directly, and the earlier you do this the better for all involved.

If your event has been identified as a **Key Event** there are some additional requirements you need to be aware of, which will outline in the next section.

Please note, there are also Strategic Events, but these are identified 12 months in advance.

Accessing expert support for Key Events events

Some events naturally require more coordination, expertise, and support to achieve their full potential. Our Campus Services teams, with decades of collective experience delivering world-class gatherings, are here to help you create something extraordinary.

When your event qualifies for enhanced support

Your event could be considered what we call a '**Key Event**' if it includes some of the following elements:

- 100+ attendees
- High-profile speakers
- Complex logistics such as multi-room or multi-day programmes
- Significant operational elements
- External audience
- Media attendance

While these criteria guide the process, the final determination involves multiple factors.

What does 'Key Event' status mean in practice

If you have been told that your event is a Key Event then in addition to booking your space, you will be asked to complete an **Event Information Sheet (EIS)**, which will help you work effectively with Campus Services teams to deliver the event experience you need.

Unlike the Space Request Form, which helps you secure an appropriate space for your event, the EIS form provides an extra level of detail on the key elements of your event to support planning, logistics and the overall event experience.

Dedicated expertise

Key Events often carry significant reputation impact or directly advance the School's five foundations. By bringing together our most experienced teams and resources, we ensure these high-stakes events achieve the best possible outcomes, protecting and enhancing LBS's global standing. This means you'll get:

- Access to event professionals who've delivered 100s of successful LBS events
- Guidance from teams who understand campus space intimately
- Support from specialists who anticipate challenges before they arise

Comprehensive coordination and support

- There is a dedicated Key Events Meeting which is the place where core Campus Services teams, like catering, AV, security, and facilities, all come together
- Proactive problem-solving from teams who've seen it all
- Advice on maximising impact within budget

[Download the Event Information Sheet \(EIS\)](#)



Your partnership commitment as a Key Event

To ensure our experts can deliver the best support, Key Events require:

1. Mandatory attendance at the Key Events Meeting

You will be invited to a session hosted on Microsoft Teams where all Campus Services teams come together. This will be your opportunity to ask questions and ensure everything you need is in place for your event. The experts joining you on the call can also help spot any gaps in your event planning and suggest solutions to any last-minute problems. **As an Event Organiser, your attendance at the Key Events Meeting held three (3) weeks before your event is essential*.**

Important: Missing this meeting could lead to the cancellation of your event.

2. Collaborative planning through the EIS document

You **must share your EIS with the Duty Manager team four (4) weeks before your event** (i.e. the week before your scheduled Key Events Meeting) by uploading it to the [Event Information Sheet submission form](#).

3. Timely decision-making to allow proper preparation

When you book your space, you will be given a list of key service contacts alongside your booking confirmation email (this information can also be found on Canvas). It is on you, as the Event Organiser, to start contacting the relevant teams early in the process.

Remember: The team's expertise transforms good events into unforgettable experiences. Whether you're planning your first major conference or your tenth, their knowledge, relationships, and problem-solving abilities are your greatest asset.

We will cover more about the Key Events process and working with Campus Services teams later in the toolkit.



Master the Event Information Sheet (EIS)

For Key Events, the EIS becomes your master planning document. It is a place to capture your essential requirements and conversations with Campus Services teams, helping everyone to collaborate and deliver a great event.

Using your EIS - how it works

- When you get your booking confirmation, if you have been flagged as a Key Event, you will be sent a link to the EIS document for you to download
- As you have conversations with Campus Services teams and develop your event plans, be sure to add the information to your EIS
- You should submit a near-final version of your EIS at least four (4) weeks before your event. You will need to upload your document to the [Event Information Sheet submission form](#)
 - While your EIS should be essentially complete upon submission, we understand that minor, last-minute changes may occur. Should any updates be necessary, please re-upload the revised EIS to the submission form. This ensures the Campus Service teams always have access to the most current version. When re-uploading, clearly indicate all updated information clearly through comments, tracked changes, or highlighted text within the document.
 - Your form will be reviewed by Campus Services teams and used as a reference resource at your mandatory Key Events Meeting, three (3) weeks before your event

Best practices

- Complete EIS sections as information becomes available
- Highlight changes when updating and make sure you upload the EIS to the Event Information Sheet submission form
- Treat your EIS as the single source of truth for your event planning

The Key Events Meeting

When:

The Key Event meetings happen on Thursday mornings. It usually takes place at 11am.

Where:

Microsoft Teams

Who attends:

Event Organisers (mandatory attendance), representatives from all Campus Services teams

How:

The invite to the mandatory Key Events Meeting three (3) weeks before your event will be emailed to the Event Organiser by the Duty Manager team - expect this email invite around four (4) weeks before your event, so one (1) week before the meeting takes place (if you do not receive an event invitation, please contact dutymanagers@london.edu)

Come prepared with:

- Specific questions for Campus Services teams
- Contingency plans for discussion
- Decision-making authority

Remember: Missing this meeting may result in event cancellation. It's that important.



Navigate on-campus catering requirements

Great events feed both minds and bodies. Our Catering team brings creativity and flexibility to every brief.

Ordering process

1. There are many ways to see what is on offer. Visit the [Eating at the School](#) page or contact the Catering Events team (Cateringevents@london.edu) for a brochure.
2. Review what is on offer and choose a menu/menus.
3. Please provide the Catering Events team with your event booking confirmation, event timings, catering requirements, cost code, and dietary requirements/any other specific notes by emailing them at Cateringevents@london.edu.
4. You will receive a catering confirmation. It is vital to read and confirm your event in writing; if you do not follow this process, your event will not go ahead.

Notice periods and cancellations

These timelines ensure our Catering team can deliver excellence. For last-minute events, contact them directly to discuss what's possible.

- Submit requirements: 30 days before the event (recommended)*
- Confirm numbers: One week (7 days) before your event
- Final adjustments: 72 hours before (emergencies only)

*We understand that last-minute event opportunities may arise, such as a high-profile speaker becoming available to give a talk at LSB. In such cases, providing 30 days' notice for catering may not always be feasible. If you submit a catering request with less than 30 days' notice, please provide a reason for the short timeframe.

Alcohol service

- Order deadline: Minimum One week (7 days) before the event
- Final adjustments: 72 hours before (emergencies only)
- Compliance critical: Non-compliance risks LBS's licence

Essential information

For all on-campus events, **you must use our official catering supplier.**

They are experienced in working with all types of LBS events and can accommodate special requests.

Only in very limited and exceptional circumstances will permission be granted to use an external catering company.



Catering best practices

Know your audience

Your event should cater to everyone's needs. Use registration forms to capture specific needs and provide a detailed dietary list to the Catering team 5 days before your event.

Things to keep in mind when ordering catering:

- Religious considerations: Account for halal, kosher requirements
- Allergies and personal preferences: Our standard catering mix includes vegetarian, vegan, and gluten-free options, but you should still inform the Catering team of any dietary restrictions

Sustainability first

As a School, we want to play our part in protecting the environment, and tackling food waste is one way we can all do this.

- Choose seasonal, local options where possible
- Be clear on your audience numbers and order the right-sized order to minimise waste
- Request the chef's choice menus for flexibility
- Allow attendees to take leftovers (provide sustainable containers)

Beyond the basics

- Green room refreshments for speakers, and the stage/lectern
- Crew catering for technical teams
- Water stations throughout the venues
- Branded coffee cups (order through shop@london.edu)

Student club catering pricing

For student club events, food and drink are charged at a discounted rate. To cover all costs, labour and sundries are added based on:

- Number of guests
- Delivery location(s)
- Event duration
(including one hour for set-up and one hour for clear-down)
- Service required
(waiting staff only, or chefs if hot food is prepared on site)

Please note that an additional 20% VAT applies when payment is processed through student clubs or external payees. Brochure prices are shown without VAT, so always factor this into your budget.

When placing your order, let the Catering Events team know whether the event is being charged to your club or sponsored, as this affects how the order is processed.





Navigate security requirements

Our Security team brings a wealth of experience in keeping our community safe and protecting the School's reputation. They're not just about managing risks - they're your partners in creating safe, successful events that run smoothly for everyone involved.

Why early engagement matters

Security considerations affect everything from your speaker selection to your venue capacity. Early collaboration ensures:

- Appropriate security measures without last-minute scrambles
- Budget allocation for any additional security needs/requirements, will fall upon the Event Organiser
- Coordination with external protection teams when required
- Compliance with licensing and legal requirements

Capacity and licensing implications

- Events with 50+ attendees serving alcohol require number management procedures
- Events with 100+ attendees trigger risk assessment by the Head of Security
- Events with 300+ attendees need agreed systems (wristbands, controlled entry)
- **Critical:** You, as an Event Organiser, are personally liable if the event exceeds its stated capacity
- **Alcohol licensing:** Non-compliance risks LBS losing its license permanently



Security planning timeline

At the initial planning stage:

- Consider security implications before confirming speakers or sending invitations
- Flag any potentially sensitive elements:
 - Speakers from companies involved in controversies (fossil fuels, pharmaceuticals, defence, etc.)
 - Organisations that might attract protests or media attention
 - Topics that could generate strong reactions or security concerns
 - Any speaker with known security requirements

At the speaker confirmation stage, or at least four (4) weeks before the event:

Notify security by emailing speakersandguests@london.edu to inform them who is speaking at your event. The Security team will review this form, paying particular attention to the following:

- Government ministers, MPs, or royalty
- CEOs of major corporations (FTSE100, S&P500)
- Potentially controversial or politically sensitive speakers
- Speakers from organisations that might attract protests
- Any speaker requiring special security arrangements

One (1) week before the event:

- Submit any final speaker changes or additions
- Confirm all security arrangements are in place

48-72 hours before the event:

- Submit the final guest list via speakersandguests@london.edu
- Close registration: No new attendees after the guest list submission without security approval

Day of event:

- Brief the Security team on VIP arrivals and any special requirements
- Maintain an open communication channel throughout the event (more information is available later in this toolkit)

Important:

As mentioned in previous sections, we appreciate that last-minute event opportunities arise. If that happens you are still required to submit the relevant speaker and guest list information, as this is a health and safety requirement. You will also need to provide a reason why you are submitting the information close to the event date.

Key contacts:

- speakersandguests@london.edu



Master AV and technical requirements

Technology can transform good events into unforgettable experiences. Start these conversations early, and when you complete your Space Request Form, make sure you are very clear on your AV needs, as your event's technical requirements will influence and inform your space allocation.

In many rooms, basic services, including microphones and campus screen, can be provided free of charge. You can contact the AV team directly at avhelp@london.edu to discuss your requirements. We advise you to contact them at least 4 weeks before your event.

AV planning timeline for complex setups and premium spaces

Events in Nuffield Hall

- At least 2 months' notice required
- Contact the AV team directly to discuss requirements
- Sound technician support is provided free of charge
- Sound desk with AV technician support
- Include a clear brief about your needs
- Note: Nuffield Hall has a static camera for basic Zoom streaming only

Complex events (multi-camera streaming, live production, special lighting)

- Minimum 3 months' notice essential
- As an estimate, costs start from £5,000 for live streaming, although please note that specialist equipment is not readily available and will require time to procure and set up - please contact AV directly to discuss your requirements (avhelp@london.edu)
- Please note that you will also need access to network ports, which are not available in every room so please ensure complex technical requirements, like multi-camera streaming, are clearly stated on your initial Space Request Form.
- Contact the AV team immediately after space confirmation

Important cost considerations

- Basic equipment (microphones, screens) = Free
- Sound desk with technician = Free
- Live streaming = Chargeable (minimum £5,000)
- External lighting beyond basic options = Additional cost
- Hybrid events warning: Hybrid events are significantly more expensive and difficult to plan than in-person only events. The static camera in venues like Nuffield Hall provides basic functionality only. For anything beyond a simple Zoom setup, you need substantial advance planning and budget.

What to include when contacting AV: Keep your initial request clear and concise:

- Event date, time and venue
- Expected audience size
- Basic or complex requirements
- Whether streaming/recording is needed
- Any special requirements (but avoid over-specifying)

Lighting limitations: Nuffield Hall and most venues have limited built-in lighting options. Anything beyond basic stage lighting requires:

- Private supplier hiring
- Full health and safety procedures
- Significant additional budget
- Contact the AV team for guidance on suppliers (avhelp@london.edu)

External AV suppliers: If you think you may need external suppliers to fulfil your requirements, please first speak to the AV team. All external suppliers must follow LBS supplier procedures, and the AV team will be able to advise you (avhelp@london.edu).



Design effective room layouts

Your space setup shapes participant experience. Think beyond traditional rows of chairs.

Layout considerations by event type

Conferences/Presentations

- Theatre style: Maximum capacity, forward focus
- Cabaret style: Networking with presentation viewing (half moon tables with 6 chairs per table)
- Ensure sightlines from all seats
- Position screens for neck comfort

Workshops/Interactive sessions

- U-shape or boardroom for under 30
- Rounds of 6-8 for larger groups
- Space for movement and activities
- Cabaret style

Networking receptions

- Mix of poseur tables and seating
- Clear flow patterns
- Dedicated food/drink stations
- Quiet zones for conversations
- Cabaret style

Hybrid events

- Camera positions for remote viewers
- Dedicated streaming station

The guest journey

Walk through your event as an attendee:

- **Arrival:** Clear signage from the building entrance
- **Registration:** Efficient flow, adequate space and attendance tracking - this is also an essential requirement as we need to know who is on campus for health and safety reasons
- **Cloakroom:** Positioned before the main space
- **Main event:** Comfortable seating, good sightlines
- **Refreshments:** Easy access, minimal queuing
- **Departure:** Clear exit routes, cloakroom retrieval

Book the North Building cloakroom

The cloakroom on the ground floor of the North Building holds up to 250 coats and provides storage for event attendees. Booking requires two separate steps:

1. **Reserve the space:** Send your completed **Cloakroom booking form** to Space Management (space@london.edu) to book the cloakroom for your event.
2. **Book a cloakroom attendant:** Once your space reservation is confirmed, contact the Catering Events team (cateringevents@london.edu) to arrange a cloakroom attendant. The cloakroom should only be used for events when it is staffed.

Important: Reserving a cloakroom space does not include staffing — these are separate requests. Items cannot be stored overnight, and bicycles, scooters and e-scooters are not permitted. It is your responsibility to ensure all items are cleared from the space at the end of your booking. All items are stored at the owner's risk.



Select and manage external venues

Sometimes your event needs a setting beyond campus. If that is the case, bookings for external venues will need to be made at least 9 months in advance to allow time for assessments and procurement. If you have any questions, please come to one of the [Event Planning Drop-in Session](#) or contact Editorial Planning (editorialplanning@london.edu).

Here's how to choose wisely.

Venue selection criteria

Location and access

- Transport links for your audience
- Parking availability
- Step-free access throughout
- Distance from the attendee base

Facilities assessment

- Capacity with comfortable spacing
- Technical infrastructure
- Catering capabilities
- Breakout space options
- Storage for materials
- Green room facilities (please note that spaces do not automatically come with a green room, so you need to include a green room request when booking your space)

Due diligence questions

- Cancellation policy details
- What's included vs additional costs
- Preferred supplier lists
- Setup/breakdown time included
- Wet weather contingencies (outdoor spaces)

Site visit checklist

Never book without visiting. During your recce:

Test the journey

- ☐ Time from the nearest station, as most guests will use public transport
- ☐ Clarity of venue signage
- ☐ Accessibility obstacles
- ☐ Local parking options

Assess the spaces

- ☐ Natural light levels
- ☐ Acoustic quality
- ☐ Temperature control
- ☐ Power outlet locations
- ☐ WiFi strength throughout
- ☐ Mobile phone signal

Meet the team

- ☐ Venue coordinator responsiveness
- ☐ Technical team expertise
- ☐ Catering quality (request tasting)
- ☐ Security procedures
- ☐ Emergency protocols, including asking about First Aid provisions

Contract negotiation

Before signing, confirm:

- All costs include VAT
- The payment schedule is manageable and agreed with relevant departments
- Minimum numbers are realistic
- Cancellation terms are clear
- Force majeure clauses included
- Insurance requirements specified



Your key Campus Services contacts

These teams bring your event to life. Engage early and often.

Space Management - space@london.edu

- First point of contact for all bookings
- Process guidance and compliance
- Cloakroom booking

Catering - cateringevents@london.edu

- Food and Beverage delivery for your events
- Support with dietary needs
- Bar service
- Service teams and cloakroom teams
- During any event, please contact the Hospitality Management team for support on +44 (0)77 0629 5968
- Cloakroom staff bookings

Audio Visual - avhelp@london.edu

- Technical requirements and support
- Equipment availability
- Live streaming and recording

Networks - [INSERT EMAIL HERE]

- Support setting up hybrid events and virtual events with external suppliers to provide appropriate network ports

Security - Use the appropriate email

Use speakersandguests@london.edu for:

- VIP and speaker protection via the Speaker Security Review Form
- Parking and access arrangements
- Guest list management via the Guest List Form

Use security@london.edu for :

- Risk assessments
- Security concerns or emergency situations

Estates- estates@london.edu (available Monday to Friday, 8am - 5pm)

Porters

- Furniture setup and room layout
- Equipment moving
- Signage placement
- Stage configuration

Cleaning

- Pre-event deep clean
- Break-time refreshes
- Post-event restoration
- Special requirements (additional charges may apply)

Maintenance

- Power and heating/cooling
- Emergency repairs
- Technical infrastructure

Event day support

Duty Managers - dutymanagers@london.edu (available 7am-7pm)

- Central coordination point
- Key Events Meeting coordination
- Leading pre-event walkthroughs
- Emergency response
- Problem-solving support
- Direct numbers:
- Sussex Place: 07966 907 265
- Sammy Ofer Centre: 07976 806 120

Welcome Desk - welcomedesk@london.edu

- Registration support staff
- Professional first impression
- Guest wayfinding assistance
- Ideally, book a welcome desk 3 weeks ahead

Gift Shop - shop@london.edu (available 7 days a week)

- Branded merchandise
- Speaker gifts
- Please note: A gift shop needs to be arranged before your event, and there is a cost associated with running this service

Post Room - postroom@london.edu

- Large delivery coordination
- International shipping
- Storage arrangements



Your venue and logistics checklist

The timelines below work for on-campus events with a 3-month lead time. Scale up or down based on your specific situation. A complex annual conference needs more time, while a responsive workshop might happen faster.

If you submit a space request at short notice, it is helpful to explain the reason for sending it so close to the event. For example, perhaps a high-profile person in your network was in London unexpectedly next week and agreed to give a talk, and given the person's profile, it was too good an opportunity to miss, and there was no way of knowing this information months ago.

12+ weeks before

- Submit Space Request Form (required for all events and space booking)
- Receive venue confirmation
- Start contacting Campus Service teams
- Begin EIS (if Key Event)

At least 4-6 weeks before

- Confirm AV requirements
- Contact Catering for initial catering discussions

At least 4 weeks before

- Submit your EIS (Key Events only)
- Finalise room layouts
- Submit speakers lists and requirements to Security
- Confirm all technical needs
- Consider requesting an event walkthrough with the Duty Manager team

2-3 weeks before

- Attend the Key Events Meeting three (3) weeks before your event (if Key Event)
- Order alcohol (if serving)
- Submit final AV requirements
- Create your signage
- Brief Welcome Desk (if using)

1 week before

- Final catering numbers
- Send guest list to security (minimum 2 days before event)
- Setup schedule confirmed
- Emergency contacts list ready
- Print your signage

Day before

- Technical rehearsal (if required)
- Final venue walk-through
- Confirm all deliveries
- Brief event team

Key reminders for venue and logistics success

Critical actions

- **Attend your Key Event meeting** - This is non-negotiable for Key Events
- **Contact AV immediately** for anything beyond basic microphones and screens
- **Use our official catering** - External caterers are only to be used in exceptional circumstances, with prior approval
- **Request green rooms separately** - They don't automatically come with your space booking

Timeline essentials

- Space requests: As early as possible
- Complex AV/streaming: 3 months minimum
- Standard AV with technician: 2 months
- Simple AV requirements: 4 weeks (via EIS if a Key Event or via email for all other events)
- Attend the Key Events Meeting 3 weeks before your event (Key Events only)

Remember: If in doubt about any requirement, ask early. It's better to check than to discover issues close to your event date.

Next step: With your venue secured and logistics underway, it's time to focus on speaker management and clearances.



6. Speaker management

The voices that bring your event to life

Speakers transform events from gatherings into experiences. The right speaker can inspire action, spark debate, and leave audiences changed. This section guides you through finding, securing, and supporting the speakers who will make your event memorable.

Whether you're inviting a Nobel laureate or your favourite faculty member, success lies in thoughtful selection, clear communication, and meticulous preparation.



Develop your speaker selection strategy

Great events start with speakers who align perfectly with your objectives and resonate with your audience.

Define your speaker criteria

Before creating wish lists, establish clear criteria:

Content alignment

- Direct expertise in your event theme
- Fresh perspectives on familiar topics
- Proven ability to engage your specific audience
- Track record of delivering actionable insights

Audience appeal

- Name recognition within your sector
- Relevance to attendee challenges
- Speaking style that matches the event's tone
- Availability for audience interaction

Diversity considerations

- Mix of backgrounds and perspectives
- Gender balance across panels
- Range of career stages
- Geographic representation

Practical factors

- Availability on your date
- Location and travel requirements
- Fee expectations for student-run events (please note that LBS does not pay for speakers)
- Technical requirements
- Accessibility requirements

Build your speaker pipeline

Tier 1: Dream speakers - would transform your event

- Require 6-12 months lead time
- May need Dean-level invitation
- These people can really help with your event promotion, so you want them to confirm 3 months before your event, if possible

Tier 2: Strong alternatives - excellent content fit

- Generally 3-6 months booking window
- Direct approach possible

Tier 3: Reliable backups - proven LBS partners

- Local or easily accessible
- Can confirm quickly
- Quality guaranteed

Top tips:

1. When seeking speakers, a good rule of thumb is to approach three times the number of individuals you need. For instance, if your event requires three speakers, you should invite nine potential speakers.
2. Don't message everyone at once. If they all say "yes", you could end up with a problem. Start with the people at the top of your list and work your way down.



Navigate VIP speaker protocols

Some speakers require special handling. Getting this right protects both your event and LBS's reputation.

High-profile speaker categories

Government officials

- Royalty, ministers, senior civil servants
- Requires a security assessment
- May need protocol briefing
- Often bring security teams

Corporate leaders

- FTSE 100/S&P 500 CEOs
- Major firm founders
- Industry titans
- May have specific requirements

Public figures

- Media personalities
- Thought leaders with large platforms
- Anyone who might attract protests

Managed prospects

- Major donors or prospects
- Key alumni relationships
- Strategic partners
- Check with Advancement first

The VIP invitation process

Who counts as a VIP?

- Government ministers and MPs
- Ambassadors and diplomats
- FTSE 100 CEOs and board members
- High-profile media personalities
- Major donors and prospects
- Anyone from organisations that might attract protests (e.g., defence contractors, oil companies)

Please keep in mind that the more VIPs in attendance or participating in your event, the more additional planning, coordination, and potential security expenses will be required, all of which should be accounted for in your timelines and budget.

1. Due diligence basics

When compiling your speaker list, conduct research to identify any potential security or reputational risks.

Google the speaker's name and organisation

Check recent news coverage

Review their LinkedIn profile

If you find anything concerning, or if you're unsure, contact security@london.edu immediately

Never decide on security or reputational risks yourself

2. Speaker clearance

Email speakersandguests@london.edu with your speaker list at least four (4) weeks before your event

Include: Name, job title, company, LinkedIn bio, alumni status (including programme code)

Flag any potential reputational concerns

Don't make your own risk assessments - let security decide. If in doubt about any speaker, contact security@london.edu immediately

3. Formal invitations from the Dean

In 99% of cases, invitations are often more impactful coming from you than via a formal Dean's letter. Only request the Dean's signature when protocol requires it, for example, for government ministers, ambassadors, etc.

Staff: Follow your departmental process for inviting VIPs

Students: Contact the Editorial Planning team at least 3+ months before the event with a draft letter (editorialplanning@london.edu) if you want to request a formal invitation from the Dean



Master the invitation process

Your invitation sets the tone for the entire speaker relationship. Make it count.

Crafting compelling invitations

Essential elements

- Clear value proposition
- Specific date and format of the event
- Expected audience profile
- Time commitment required
- Available support
- Response (RSVP) deadline

The personal touch for VIP invites

- Reference their specific work
- Explain why them specifically
- Highlight mutual benefits
- Connect to LBS mission

Invitation channels

Below are some channels you can use to invite speakers.

Pro tip: Whatever channel(s) you use, be respectful and always give people an easy out, such as, "We understand if your schedule doesn't permit...". If you do this, it is not just polite, but statistically, people are more likely to say "yes". Whilst if they say no, it opens doors for future invitations.

For external speakers

- Leverage warm connections
- Personal email
- Phone call if a relationship exists
- A formal letter on letterhead

For faculty

- Email with programme context
- Highlight student learning benefits
- Please be aware of teaching times and schedules - offer flexibility where possible, and it is essential to provide appropriate notice

For alumni and donors

We recommend reaching out to the Advancement team, who look after Alumni Engagement, if you want help finding an alumni speaker, as it may be best to route the invitation through them - please email ADVstakeholderops@london.edu.

Alternatively, if you have identified a high-profile alumni or donors that you would like to invite, you should inform Advancement first, as we want to avoid situations where multiple Event Organisers are requesting things from/of alumni and key donors.

When inviting alumni or donors:

- Reference their LBS connection
- Emphasise the value they add to the community
- Make logistics easy



Create comprehensive speaker briefings

Well-briefed speakers deliver better performances. Invest time here.

Essential briefing components

Event context

- Theme and objectives
- Full programme schedule
- Other speakers/panels
- Expected outcomes
- Sponsor recognition (if applicable)

Audience intelligence

- Demographic breakdown
- Seniority levels
- Industry sectors
- Geographic spread
- Key interests/challenges

Content guidance

- Key messages to reinforce
- Topics to avoid
- Time allocation
- Q&A expectations
- Interaction preferences

Logistics clarity

- Arrival time and location
- Parking/transport arrangements
- Green room facilities
- Explain the AV and stage set-up
- Inform the speaker on how to supply their presentation, including formats allowed
- Run through how the Q&A section will work (if required)
- Specify if there is a dress code
- Technical check timing
- Departure arrangements

Technical requirements

- Presentation format and deadline
- Microphone preferences
- Screen setup
- Recording permissions
- Live streaming notices

Briefing timeline

- At least 6 weeks before: Send initial briefing document
- Around 4 weeks before: Schedule a briefing call
- No later than 2 weeks before: Share the final programme
- 1 week before: Confirm all arrangements
- Day before: Final check-in

Panel coordination

Panels require extra coordination:

- Schedule a pre-event call with all panellists
- Share discussion themes in advance
- Clarify the moderation approach
- Agree on time allocation
- Establish ground rules
- Seating plan on stage so mics are fitted properly

Here is an example **London Business School Speaker briefing** to help you successfully prepare your speaker(s).



Manage travel and accommodation

Smooth logistics keep speakers focused on content, not concerns.

Travel arrangements

Booking protocols

- Clarify who in your team is booking travel
- Agree on expense parameters
- Provide multiple options
- Confirm accessibility needs
- Share local transport info

International speakers

- Visa support letters
- Airport transfer options
- Currency/payment info (if a fee has been approved)
- Local contact numbers
- Jet lag considerations

Accommodation standards

Preferred partners

- Contact dutymanagers@london.edu for:
- LBS-negotiated hotel rates
- Proximity recommendations
- Accessibility confirmation
- Direct billing options

Speaker preferences

- Room type requirements
- Dietary restrictions
- Late checkout needs
- Companion arrangements

Budget considerations

Always clarify early:

- Speaker fees (if any, as a reminder, LSB does not pay speakers)
- Travel class policies
- Meal allowances
- Incidental coverage
- Payment timelines



Perfect green room management

A green room is a space backstage where speakers can relax, prepare, or network before, during, or after an event.

Green rooms must be booked separately as they don't come automatically with your venue booking. For VIPs, we recommend you book a green room specifically when completing your Space Request Form. Please note, you may need multiple green rooms if you have more than one VIP.

The green room sets the tone for a speaker's performance. Therefore, it's important to get the experience right. Once again, keep in mind that you need to request a green room when making your space request.

Green room staffing

Assign dedicated team members to:

- Greet speakers on arrival
- Make introductions
- Handle last-minute requests
- Brief on programme changes
- Escort the speaker to the stage

Critical: Ensure the green room is secure or staffed continuously. Speakers leave valuables here.

Essential provisions

Comfort basics

- Quiet, private space
- Comfortable seating
- Temperature control
- Natural light (ideally)
- Full-length mirror

Refreshments

- Water
- Hot beverages
- Light snacks
- Dietary options noted

Technical support

- Power outlets
- WiFi password
- Live relay
- Comfort monitor for the stage
- Tech support contact

Personal touches

- Name badges ready
- Programme copies and copies of briefing documents
- Speaker gifts
- Cloak facilities
- Quiet spaces



Handle speaker consent properly

Legal compliance protects everyone. Never skip this step.

[INSERT LINKS TO OFFICIAL FORMS]

Essential consent areas

Recording permissions

- Audio recording
- Video recording
- Photography
- Live streaming
- Future use rights

Content sharing

- Presentation slides
- Speaking notes
- Social media clips
- Website features
- Marketing materials

Media engagement

- Interview permissions
- Quote approval
- Photo usage
- Press attendance
- Chatham House rules

Consent process

1. **Include in invitation:**
Mention recording/streaming plans
2. **Send formal consent:**
[Need speaker consent form template]
3. **Secure signature:**
Before event promotion
4. **Confirm on day:**
Remind before recording
5. **Archive records:**
Keep for [clarify retention period]

Remember: No consent = no recording.
Plan accordingly.



Work with security on speaker clearance

We have previously covered how to inform Security before your event by emailing speakersandguests@london.edu. However, Security is a key partner for you for reasons beyond providing clearance.

Security cost implications

Be aware:

- High-profile speakers may require additional security, and you, as the Event Organiser, will have to cover any extra costs
- Discuss the budget impact early
- Plan contingencies

Parking and access

- Security manages:
- VIP parking allocation
- Temporary access cards
- Swipe access modifications
- Escort requirements

In your security requests, be sure to include:

- Vehicle registrations (if applicable)
- Arrival times
- Duration needed
- Special access requirements



Your speaker management checklist

Many new Event Organisers find that the following project flow work when planning an event.

Stage 1

- Define speaker criteria
- Create target list
- We recommend that you check with Advancement for managed relationships with alumni (where applicable) and donors by emailing ADVstakeholderops@london.edu
- Begin high-profile invitations

Stage 2

- Send standard invitations
- Submit Dean's signature requests (if needed)
- Book travel/accommodation upon confirmation

Stage 3

- Notify security of your speakers (at least 4 weeks before your event)
- Send comprehensive briefings
- Schedule briefing calls
- Obtain signed consent forms for video and photography (if required)

Stage 4

- Confirm all arrangements
- Do technical run-throughs
- Share the final programme
- Brief green room team

Stage 5

- Final speaker check-in
- Confirm arrival times
- For virtual events test all technology
- Review security arrangements

Event day

- Meet speakers on arrival
- Onsite rehearsals
- Provide green room support
- Handle media (if present)
- Gather feedback

Elevate through excellence

Remember: Speakers judge LBS by how they're treated. Every interaction reflects on our institution. By following these protocols, you're not just managing logistics - you're building relationships that benefit our entire community.

Next step: Now that you've thought about speakers, it's time to plan registration and manage your attendee experience.





7. Registration & attendee management

Start with clarity: What do you actually need?

The registration process is more than a transaction. It's the first real interaction with your event. Make it count!

Your registration requirements drive everything else. Before opening any platform or designing any form, answer these fundamental questions.

Essential considerations:

- What information is genuinely necessary? (Remember: every additional field increases abandonment rates)
- Will attendees register guests? Do you need their details for badges, or just numbers?
- Are you charging for tickets? If yes, what's your cancellation policy?
- Is this a hybrid event requiring separate in-person and virtual registration?
- Do different audiences need different ticket types or pricing?
- Will you offer packages (e.g. a day event plus evening reception)?
- Do you need promotional options (early bird rates, group discounts)?
- How will you communicate with registrants (confirmation emails, joining instructions)?

Choose your event platform wisely

Having a place for your audience to learn more about your event and to register is non-negotiable. At LBS, your position (staff or student), audience, and event size determine your platform.

Campus Groups (mandatory for all student events)

- Your primary platform for student audiences - https://clubs.london.edu/home_login
- Integrated with student systems
- Free to use for clubs
- Contact the SA to get access (safinance@london.edu)
- We do not recommend using Campus Groups for external audiences as the user experience has not been designed for non-LSB stakeholders (see Eventcase)

Critical technical tip: Once you start selling tickets, NEVER edit your existing event. If you need to add more tickets or change pricing, create a new ticket type or tier instead. Editing live tickets will cause system errors.

[Campus Groups](#)

Eventscase (for external audiences only)

- Use when alumni, public, or other universities attend
- Enables professional ticketing features
- Never use other platforms—proceeds won't be added to club balances
- Contact SA Finance for access and support (safinance@london.edu)



Design your registration form

Every field matters. Capture what you need, respect what you don't.

Core information to consider

Personal details

- Professional title (Dr, Prof, Sir, Lady)
- Full name (as they want it displayed)
- Email address (usually sufficient for contact)

Alumni information (for reporting and networking)

- Programme code including programme and graduation year (e.g. MBA2024)
- Please forward your list of alumni attendees to ADVstakeholderops@london.edu for awareness.

Professional details (for badges and networking)

- Job title
- Organisation

Accessibility requirements (special category data)

- Dietary requirements
- Access needs
- Mobility considerations

Critical: Special category data requires extra protection. Remove names when sharing with caterers. We recommend using password-protected documents when sharing guest lists.

Key point: You can't use data beyond the purposes of the event unless you've got systems and processes in place to handle marketing and communications moving forward. Only collect the core information you need for the event.



Master GDPR compliance

Data protection isn't optional - it is a legal requirement which you are responsible for. Event Organisers and LBS as an institution have legal requirements regarding the handling of personal data, and failing to follow best practice can have serious implications from both a legal and stakeholder relationship perspective.

Before you start

Legal requirements:

- Include the School's Privacy Notice for Events: <https://www.london.edu/about/london-business-school/policies-and-legislation/privacy-notice-for-events>
- State clearly how data will be used
- Explain the legal basis for processing

Photography and filming consent

Prior to the event:

- Always inform attendees about photography/filming plans
- Share the Privacy Notice for Events
- Special considerations:

For under-18s: All LBS events are designated as 18 and over. In the rare, pre-approved circumstances where under-18s are permitted to attend, you must use the Child Contributor Consent Form (available from dpo@london.edu). Contact Space Management in the first instance if under-18s may be present at your event.

For vulnerable adults: Contact dpo@london.edu for guidance.

During the event:

- Operate an opt-out approach for large events
- Use Media Release Forms for smaller, intimate settings
- Display clear signage: "Photography and filming in progress. Please inform staff if you prefer not to be photographed"
- Make an announcement at the start
- Consider red dots on badges for those opting out

Data protection summary

- When setting up your registration page, only request information you genuinely need because the more fields you require, the more people will abandon registration
- Include clear data protection statements explaining how information will be used
- For guidance on data protection requirements, refer to [data protection guidance](#)



Set your ticket strategy

Pricing psychology meets practical reality.

Ticket types that work

Standard structure:

- Student rate: 50-70% discount (builds future alumni relationships)
- Alumni rate: 10-20% discount (acknowledges their connection)
- External rate: Full price (reflects true value)

Dynamic pricing to drive urgency:

- Super early bird (3+ months): Maximum discount for committed attendees
- Early bird (6-8 weeks): Smaller discount, building momentum
- Standard pricing: Full value as event approaches
- Last-minute premium: Higher price for late decisions (optional)

Value-added options:

- VIP packages with speaker access
- Table bookings with premium placement
- Combined tickets for multi-part events
- Group discounts for 5+ attendees

Cancellation policy essentials:

- State clearly at the point of purchase
- Include in confirmation emails
- Be consistent in application
- Consider offering transfers rather than refunds

Navigate the no-show challenge

The uncomfortable truth: Your registration numbers lie. Here's how to manage reality.

The mathematics of attendance

Typical no-show rates:

- Paid events: 20-30%
- Free events: Up to 50%
- Morning events: Higher no-shows
- Evening events: Lower no-shows
- Bad weather: Add 10-15% no-shows

Waitlist management:

- Activate when 80% subscribed
- Send reminders to registered attendees, prompting them to cancel if they can no longer attend
- Release waitlist spots 48 hours before the event
- Keep the waitlist engaged with updates about their status
- Document waitlist conversion rates for future planning

Document everything

Track your actual no-show rates to inform future planning. Your successors will thank you.





Handle data like you would want your personal information treated

Think your guest list is just a list of names? It's so much more. It's relationships, insights, and responsibilities.

Registration monitoring

For complex events, create regular reports showing:

- Total registrations vs capacity
- Registration pace (daily/weekly)
- Ticket type distribution (if relevant)
- Geographic spread (if relevant)
- Payment status (if relevant)

Data sharing protocols:

- Remove personal details where possible
- Password-protect any files with personal data
- Share only with those who genuinely need access
- Delete files after the event (keeping only summary data or data you have consent to store and use again in the future)

Testing is non-negotiable

Before going live:

- Test every registration journey
- Check all confirmation emails
- Verify payment processing
- Test with different browsers/devices
- Have someone unfamiliar with the event test usability
- Use dummy card details in test mode for payment testing



The Dean card: When and how to play it

Inviting the Dean adds gravitas but requires careful orchestration, and demands on the Dean's time mean that attendance is often challenging.

The formal invitation process

When the Dean's involvement is appropriate:

- Major institutional events
- Key strategic partnerships
- Significant fundraising galas
- High-profile speaker events
- Alumni milestone celebrations
- Flagship student conferences

How to request the Dean's attendance:

For all events (students and staff):

- Email editorialplanning@london.edu
- Allow a minimum of 3 months' notice (ideally 6 months' notice for the best chance of success)
- Never contact the Dean's office directly

Required information for your request – formal request to Editorial Planning, clearly stating:

- What you want the Dean to do (opening remarks, keynote, panel participation)
- Specific date and time
- Duration needed (be realistic)
- Whether you have flexibility on timing
- Event context and expected audience
- Why the Dean's involvement adds value

What happens next:

- Editorial Planning reviews your initial request to make sure it is suitable for consideration
- They liaise with the Dean's office
- You'll receive a response (typically within 2 weeks)
- If approved by the Dean's office, you'll receive a detailed briefing form
- You may be invited to a pre-event briefing meeting with the Dean
- Prepare for additional security requirements

If the Dean is unavailable, Editorial Planning will advise on alternatives.

Make it worthwhile

If you're inviting the Dean, ensure the event warrants this level of engagement.

High-profile external speakers, significant strategic value, or major institutional moments justify the request.





Platform troubleshooting

Campus Groups issues:

Contact SA directly - sa@london.edu

Eventscase problems:

Email SA Finance -
safinance@london.edu

GDPR questions:

Email dpo@london.edu

Support selecting a platform:

Email editorialplanning@london.edu

Remember: Registration sets the tone

Your registration process is often the first substantial interaction attendees have with your event. Make it smooth, professional, and welcoming. Every friction point in registration raises doubt about the event itself.

Focus on what matters: capturing essential information, respecting privacy, and creating anticipation for what's to come. The best registration process is one nobody remembers, because it just worked.

Next step: With attendees registered and data secured, it's time to spread the word. Section 8 covers working with Communications to amplify your reach.



8. Promotion, Communications and PR

Whether you're organising a student-led conference, an alumni reunion or a major School event, effective communication is essential to your success.

With over 800 events hosted annually at LBS, your event needs to stand out or have a clear strategy to get people to attend. Your messaging is key here.

Think back to your answers when you were planning your event and considering your compelling event proposition. Is your event a pain reliever for the audience? Is it a gain creator? Or does it offer something unique?

Once you have your messaging right and your registration platform up and running, this section of the toolkit provides advice on how to promote your event effectively, from leveraging your personal networks to accessing central promotional support when your event aligns with School priorities.

Start with self-promotion

Your most powerful promotional tools

Successful events are promoted by passionate advocates. Your personal networks and audience-specific channels consistently deliver better engagement than corporate communications alone. Here's why: you're speaking directly to people who share your interests, rather than competing for attention in channels that serve diverse audiences.

Personal networks and LinkedIn

LinkedIn is your most powerful tool

- Personal posts typically achieve more engagement than organisational posts
- Ask your team members, speakers, classmates and colleagues to share with their networks
- Provide them with template posts, images and key messages

Other personal channels

- **WhatsApp and other messaging apps**
- **Personal social media** (Bluesky, X, Instagram) - Your social media channels can be very impactful if you have the right audience there



Audience-specific channels you control

Before seeking central support, make sure you are maximising these channels:

For student events:

- **Campus Groups** (mandatory for all student events) - your primary promotion platform - https://clubs.london.edu/home_login
- **Club mailing lists** - Direct access to engaged members
- **Club social media accounts** - Instagram, LinkedIn, etc.
- **Programme cohort channels** - Year group WhatsApp groups, programme newsletters

For alumni events:

- **Alumni mailing lists** - Regional and industry-specific
- **Alumni LinkedIn groups** - Professional network groups
- **Class representatives** - Leverage year group connections

For faculty/staff events:

Your colleagues are your first audience:

- **Team meetings** - Personal invitations work best
- **Internal team channels** - Teams groups, Teams channels

Accessing central promotional support

When to request central support

LBS hosts over 800 events annually. We focus our central promotional support on events that:

- Align with LBS's five foundations
- Support current editorial priorities
- Feature high-profile speakers or VIPs
- Serve strategic School objectives
- Appeal to broad audiences (not niche or specialist topics)
- Demonstrate clear value to the wider LBS community

How to request promotional support

Step 1: Complete the Event Promotion Form

- Access the form: [Event Promotion Form](#)
- Submit at least 4-6 weeks before your event to allow adequate review and planning time (if you are submitting a request later, please give a reason why)

Step 2: Provide required information

- Event title
- Event blurb (50-100 words) - make it compelling!
- Registration link (mandatory - all events must have a registration link - email RSVPs are not accepted for central promotion)
- Target audience(s)
- Any promotional assets (images, logos)

Step 3: Weekly review process

- The event promo group meets weekly to review all submissions
- You'll receive confirmation of the support the Editorial Planning team can offer you
- Not all events will be promoted through all channels. The team determines the most appropriate mix based on your event details, target audience and strategic alignment. The team will match your event to the most relevant channels.



Strategic support

For major events with significant strategic importance, Editorial Planning can also offer collaborative support beyond event promotion. This could include:

- Identifying potential PR opportunities
- Content strategy development
- Gap analysis in current planning
- Refining messaging and key communications
- Developing media invitation strategy (if appropriate)
- Social media planning
- Speaker communications briefing
- Day-of social media planning
- Post-event content planning

To discuss the support available you can book a slot at an upcoming [events planning drop-in session](#), or contact the Editorial Planning team directly at editorialplanning@london.edu.

Planning your promotional activities

Recommended sequence for all events

Every event is different, so the following is not a strict rule but rather a helpful reference based on best practices and experiences from successful event campaigns previously run by the LBS community.

Stage 1

- ☐ Define your key messages and audience segments
- ☐ Set up your registration platform
- ☐ Create marketing materials
- ☐ Begin planning your promotion strategy

Stage 2

- ☐ Submit the Event Promotion Form for central support (if relevant)
- ☐ Launch registration with clear calls to action
- ☐ Begin promotion to your personal networks
- ☐ Prepare social media content calendar

Stage 3

- ☐ Full marketing push launches across all channels
- ☐ Deploy approved central promotional support (if applicable)
- ☐ Media invitations sent (if applicable - see media section)
- ☐ Intensive personal network outreach

Stage 4 (usually a few weeks before your event)

- ☐ Create urgency with deadline messaging
- ☐ Second wave of personal network promotion
- ☐ Reminder through approved central channels
- ☐ Confirm any photography/filming arrangements

Stage 5 (the week of your event)

- ☐ Final push communications
- ☐ Reminder emails to registered attendees
- ☐ Last-minute promotion via personal networks
- ☐ Brief your team on the social media plan for the day



Media relations and PR

Before inviting the media

Media attendance requires careful handling to protect the School's relationships with journalists. If you're considering media attendance:

You can contact Editorial Planning directly, or staff can go to their existing LBS communication partner (if you have an existing relationship):

- Email editorialplanning@london.edu or book a slot at an [event planning drop-in session](#)
- Please do not use the Event Promotion Form for media requests
- Allow at least 6 weeks for media planning

The team will help you:

- Assess if media attendance is appropriate
- Develop media invitation strategy
- Brief speakers on media handling
- Coordinate on-the-day media management

For urgent or last-minute requests, go to the School's Press team

If you need support less than 6 weeks out from your event, for example, in a last-minute PR or media emergency, please contact the Press team directly (via press@london.edu)





Creating compelling content

Key messaging framework

1. The hook - What makes your event unmissable?

- Lead with outcomes, not just content
- Create an emotional connection
- Highlight the unique value proposition

2. The details - Clear, scannable information

- Date, time, location prominently displayed
- Speaker highlights
- Who should attend and why

3. The call to action - Make it easy to act

- Clear "Register now" button
- Registration deadline
- What happens next

Example messaging

For student audiences: "Discover how to navigate the consulting recruitment process with partners from McKinsey, BCG and Bain. Get insider tips that helped 50+ LBS students land offers last year. Limited spaces available - register by [date]."

For alumni audiences: "Join fellow alumni to explore how AI is transforming finance. Hear from LBS faculty and industry leaders shaping the future of fintech. Network with 100+ professionals driving innovation. Secure your place today."

Content creation

Please note: The central team does not create event content unless pre-agreed. Most events don't need custom designs - strong photography and clear messaging are usually sufficient.

Focus on:

- High-quality photography from previous events
- Clear, compelling messaging
- Consistent use of LBS brand elements - see the [LSB Brand Guidelines](#)



Social media best practices

Channel strategy

LinkedIn - Best for professional content

- Focus on learning outcomes and speaker insights
- Tag @londonbusinessschool
- Use #WhyILoveLBS

Instagram - Community and culture

- Behind-the-scenes content
- Day-of stories
- Testimonials
- Use #WhyILoveLBS

Bluesky and X - News and updates

- Event announcements
- Live updates during events
- Links to fuller content
- Use #WhyILoveLBS

Photography, videos and privacy

Before your event

- Create a very clear brief of what you want and how the content will be used, as this influences the approach and creative direction (if you need help with the briefing process please contact editorialplanning@london.edu)
- Include a photography and/or video notice in registration
- Share the School's Privacy Notice for Events
- If under-18s have been approved to attend in exceptional circumstances, parental consent is required
- Allow opt-out options

During your event

- Display photography and/or filming signage
- Make an announcement at the start of the event
- Reserve seating outside camera view
- Use visual indicators for opt-outs, such as brightly coloured, highly visible items like wristbands or lanyards that signal their preference not to be photographed/filmed, and make sure you inform the videographer and/or photographer to make them aware

After your event

- Store images securely
- Use only for stated purposes
- Share with School channels where appropriate



Brand guidelines

All event communications must follow LBS brand guidelines:

- Use approved logos and lock-ups
- Follow colour palette (LBS Blue and Red)
- Use approved fonts
- Maintain clear space around logos

Our tone of voice

Everything we write reflects our personality:

- **Curious** - Create possibility and fresh perspectives
- **Open** - Use inviting, everyday language
- **Rigorous** - Be specific and precise
- **Inspiring** - Create a vision and show how to achieve it

Writing guidelines:

- Please use British English spelling
- Sentence case for headings
- Clear, concise, action-oriented
- Focus on audience benefits

Measuring success

Track your promotional effectiveness:

Pre-event:

- Registration numbers vs target
- Email open/click rates
- Social media engagement
- Personal network responses

During the event:

- Attendance vs registered
- Social media reach
- Media coverage (if applicable)

Post-event:

- Follow-up engagement
- Content shares
- Next event interest

Key contacts and support

- [Event promotion form](#)
- **PR and media queries:**
editorialplanning@london.edu
- **Brand and templates:**
content@london.edu

Remember: Your passion and personal advocacy are your event's greatest promotional assets. Start with your networks, tell your story compellingly, and use central support to amplify your reach when your event serves the broader LBS community.



9. Accessibility & inclusivity

Create events where everyone belongs

At London Business School, diversity is our strength. Our community spans 155+ nationalities, multiple faiths, varied abilities, and diverse ways of thinking and learning. Your event should reflect and celebrate this richness.

Creating truly inclusive events isn't about ticking boxes - it's about anticipating needs, removing barriers, and ensuring every attendee can fully participate and contribute. This section helps you build accessibility into your event from the ground up, not as an afterthought.

Start with inclusive design principles

The most successful accessible events are those designed with inclusion from day one. Think of accessibility as expanding your reach, not limiting your options.

The universal design approach

When you design for the margins, you create better experiences for everyone:

- **Captions help everyone:** Not just those with hearing impairments, but also non-native speakers and anyone in a noisy environment
- **Clear signage benefits all:** From first-time campus visitors to those with cognitive differences
- **Flexible formats work better:** Offering both in-person and virtual options serves parents, international participants, and those with mobility challenges
- **Quiet spaces help many:** Supporting neurodivergent attendees while providing refuge for anyone needing a moment to recharge

Build inclusion into your registration

Your registration form is often the first opportunity to understand and plan for attendee needs. Include this standard question:

"Do you have any accessibility requirements or dietary preferences we should know about? Please share any information that will help us ensure you can fully participate in this event."

Follow this with:

- A text field for specific requirements
- Assurance that information will be handled confidentially
- Contact details for further discussion if needed

Remember: **Not everyone will disclose their needs at registration. Design for inclusion regardless of what's declared.**



Physical accessibility requirements

Everybody should be able to navigate your event with dignity and independence.

Communicate accessibility needs early

When completing your Space Request Form, clearly state any accessibility requirements:

Include in your request

- Any speakers or VIP guests with mobility requirements
- Expected attendees who use wheelchairs or mobility aids
- Need for step-free access throughout
- Requirements for accessible toilets nearby
- Any other physical access considerations

Space Management will use this information to recommend the most suitable space for your needs. They know which venues best accommodate different accessibility requirements and will ensure your allocated space works for everyone.

Once your space is confirmed

- Verify the specific accessibility features of your allocated venue - most lecture theatres have limited accessibility for speakers with mobility requirements - Space Management will suggest alternatives if needed
- Confirm clear and accessible routes from the building entrance to your event space (including lift access where needed)
- For Nuffield Hall events, a ramp is available for stage access when required

Off-campus venues

- Request the venue's accessibility statement
- Conduct a site visit focusing on accessibility
- You can check the [AccessAble website](#) for detailed accessibility guides for specific locations and buildings
- Check transport links and accessible parking
 - Parking: Share how far the nearest car park is from the building.
 - Maps & Guides: If you have multiple entrances or tricky access, provide a simple map or guide.
 - Pinpointing Locations: Use What Three Words to help people find the exact spot.
 - Public Transport: Let visitors know how easy it is to reach the building by bus, train, or tram.
 - Taxi Info: Share details of local taxi firms that operate nearby if possible.

Verify emergency evacuation procedures for disabled attendees

Creating accessible layouts

Seating arrangements

- Reserve front spaces for attendees with visual or hearing impairments
- Integrate wheelchair spaces throughout the venue, not just at the back
- Include companion seats next to wheelchair spaces
- Ensure clear sightlines from all positions
- Allow 1.5m clearance for wheelchair navigation
- Confirm there are enough chairs for all attending, and they can all see the presenter and presentation
- Ensure that if required, you can provide chairs and desks that can be adjusted to accommodate individual needs and chairs with arms/neck/back rests, and footrests, etc.

Registration and networking areas

- Position registration desks at standing and seated heights
- Create wide corridors for circulation (minimum 1.2m)
- Provide seating in networking spaces
- Ensure refreshment stations are accessible from multiple heights



Dietary considerations

Food brings people together - ensure nobody is excluded from this communal experience.

Managing dietary requirements effectively

Collection and communication

- ❑ Gather requirements at registration (allergies, intolerances, preferences, religious requirements)
- ❑ Create a master dietary requirements list - remove names when sharing with caterers for data protection
- ❑ Brief the Catering team at least one week before your event
- ❑ Request clear food labelling at the event
- ❑ Have the catering manager available during service to answer questions

Standard provisions to include

- Vegetarian and vegan options (minimum 20% of total catering)
- Gluten-free and diabetic-friendly alternatives
- Halal options (particularly important given our diverse community)
- Kosher meals (arranged through approved suppliers when requested)
- Nut-free options clearly marked

Service considerations

- Position special dietary options prominently, not hidden
- Serve special meals first to avoid cross-contamination
- Brief serving staff on ingredients and allergens
- Keep ingredient lists available for review

Pro tip: Our Catering team are experts at managing complex dietary requirements. Engage them early for menu planning that naturally includes diverse options rather than treating them as exceptions - cateringevents@london.edu



Neurodiversity accommodations

Create environments where different ways of thinking and processing are supported, not challenged.

Environmental adjustments

Sensory considerations

- Provide a quiet room or designated calm space
- Offer noise-reducing headphones at registration
- Use natural or adjustable lighting where possible
- Remove glares from using, for example using curtains or blinds, if required
- Avoid sudden loud noises or flashing lights
- Maintain consistent, comfortable room temperatures

Information and communication

- Share detailed agendas in advance, including timings and room changes
- Provide visual schedules and clear signage
- Use clear, jargon-free language in all communications
- Offer materials in multiple formats (visual, written, verbal)
- Record sessions for later review when possible

Programme design

- Build in regular breaks (minimum 15 minutes every 90 minutes)
- Communicate that additional comfort breaks are always acceptable
- Avoid packed schedules - allow transition time between sessions
- Consider offering "early bird" registration slots to avoid queues
- Provide advance access to presentation materials

Supporting different communication styles

- Welcome various forms of participation (written questions, verbal contributions, anonymous submissions)
- Don't mandate group activities - offer alternatives
- Allow attendees to step out when needed without explanation
- Use clear, direct communication without idioms or metaphors
- Provide written instructions alongside verbal ones

Multi-faith provisions

Respect and accommodate the diverse spiritual needs of our global community.

Prayer and reflection spaces on campus

- Prayer room in Laing House (multi-faith facility)
- Reflection room in the Sammy Ofer Centre
- Ensure all event staff know these locations
- Include prayer room information in your event communications

Timing considerations

- Check major religious calendars when scheduling
- During Ramadan (typically March-April), consider:
- Later start times to accommodate those fasting
- Scheduling breaks to coincide with prayer times
- Avoiding lunch-focused networking
- Providing iftar arrangements for evening events
- Be mindful of Friday prayers (Jumu'ah) when scheduling
- Consider Jewish Sabbath for Friday evening/Saturday events

Inclusive scheduling

- Avoid scheduling during major religious holidays
- When conflicts are unavoidable, offer alternative participation methods
- Build in flexibility for prayer times
- Consider offering recordings for those unable to attend due to religious observances



Inclusive language

Communication sets the tone for belonging. Every word should reinforce that all attendees are valued.

Registration and communications

Collecting personal information

- Use inclusive pronoun options (she/her, he/him, they/them, prefer not to say)
- Avoid binary gender options - include "non-binary," "prefer to self-describe," and "prefer not to say"
- Allow preferred name fields separate from legal names
- Make titles optional, not mandatory

Event communications

- Use gender-neutral language ("everyone" not "ladies and gentlemen")
- Avoid assumptions about attendees' backgrounds or experiences
- Include pronunciation guides for speakers' names
- Test all communications, and if in doubt, sense check with a colleague before sending

Creating inclusive presentations

- Use diverse imagery representing various ethnicities, abilities, ages, and backgrounds
- Ensure a minimum font size of 24pt for presentations. Avoid script fonts or those with all capital letters.
- Use high contrast colours (avoid red/green combinations)
- Steer away from overly bright or distracting palettes, clashing neon, flashing or changing colours, or patterns
- Avoid filling presentation with a wall of text. Too much text can overwhelm
- Describe visual content verbally for those with visual impairments
- Avoid cultural references that exclude international attendees
- Face your audience. Try not to turn your back or cover your face when speaking (e.g. when writing on a board), as this makes lip reading and understanding harder.



Sign language and captioning

Ensure your content is accessible to attendees with hearing impairments.

British Sign Language (BSL) interpretation

When to provide BSL

- When requested by an attendee
- For events focusing on inclusion or accessibility topics

Booking interpreters

- Book through agencies at least 4 weeks in advance – please contact the SA directly for advice and support - sa@london.edu
- Provide materials to interpreters one week before the event
- Book two interpreters for events over one hour (they alternate every 20-30 minutes)
- Position interpreters with good lighting against a plain background
- Reserve front seating for BSL users with clear sightlines to interpreters

Live captioning options

For in-person events

- AI-powered captioning (cost-effective, 85-90% accuracy)
- Professional stenographers (higher cost, 95%+ accuracy)
- Display captions on screens visible from all seats
- Provide individual devices when main screen viewing is difficult

For virtual and hybrid events

- Enable platform auto-captions (Teams, Zoom)
- Consider professional captioning for important content
- Always record with captions for post-event access
- Share transcripts after the event

For pre-recorded videos, make sure you are always using accurate closed captions.

Technical note: All LBS lecture theatres and Nuffield Hall have induction loops installed. Always confirm these are activated for your event.





Family-friendly considerations

Support attendees balancing professional development with family responsibilities.

Parent and carer support

Timing considerations

- Avoid very early starts or late finishes that conflict with school runs
- Consider school holidays when planning
- Offer virtual participation options for those with caring responsibilities
- Record key sessions for asynchronous viewing

On-site provisions

- Designate a private room for feeding and baby changing
- Provide comfortable seating and changing facilities
- Set up a buggy park near the entrance
- Include family facilities on your venue map
- Stock basic supplies (wipes, disposal bags) if budget allows

Child-friendly options (when appropriate)

- Consider whether your event could welcome accompanied children
- If yes, provide quiet activities or a supervised play area
- Clearly communicate your policy in advance
- Ensure food options include child-friendly choices

Supporting various care needs

- Acknowledge that care responsibilities extend beyond childcare
- Be flexible with attendance requirements
- Offer dial-in options for portions of the event
- Don't schedule mandatory sessions during typical care hours



Your accessibility checklist

Here is a useful checklist that others have found helpful in ensuring nothing is overlooked:

Stage 1

- ☐ Include accessibility questions in registration
- ☐ Audit venue accessibility
- ☐ Check religious calendars and term dates
- ☐ Plan for dietary requirements collection

Stage 2

- ☐ Book BSL interpreters if required
- ☐ Arrange captioning services
- ☐ Confirm accessible transport options
- ☐ Create accessibility information sheet

Stage 3

- ☐ Brief all staff on accessibility arrangements
- ☐ Confirm dietary requirements with catering
- ☐ Test all assistive technology
- ☐ Send accessibility information to attendees

Stage 4

- ☐ Provide materials to interpreters/captioners
- ☐ Confirm quiet space arrangements
- ☐ Review emergency evacuation plans
- ☐ Prepare accessibility supplies (headphones, etc.)

Stage 5- Day of event

- ☐ Arrive early to check all accessibility arrangements
- ☐ Brief registration team on special requirements
- ☐ Ensure clear signage is in place
- ☐ Have belong@london.edu contact ready for issues

Stage 6 - After the event

- ☐ Seek feedback on accessibility provisions
- ☐ Document lessons learned
- ☐ Share recordings with captions
- ☐ Thank attendees for sharing their needs

Get expert support

You're not alone in creating inclusive events. These resources and contacts are here to help:

Key contacts

- Accessibility advice: belong@london.edu
- Student Wellbeing Services: wellbeing@london.edu
- Catering (dietary requirements): cateringevents@london.edu
- AV (hearing loops, captioning): avhelp@london.edu



The business case for inclusion

Accessible events aren't just the right thing to do - they're better events:

- **Wider reach:** You access talent and perspectives you'd otherwise miss
- **Innovation:** Diverse audiences generate richer discussions and outcomes
- **Reputation:** LBS's commitment to inclusion attracts world-class participants
- **Legal compliance:** We meet our obligations under the Equality Act 2010
- **Future-ready:** You develop skills for our increasingly diverse world

Creating inclusive events is an ongoing learning process. Each event teaches us something new about removing barriers and creating belonging. Share your experiences and learning with colleagues - together, we're building a more inclusive LBS.

Remember: Genuine effort and continuous improvement are the goals. Start where you are, use what you have, do what you can. Your commitment to inclusion matters more than flawless execution.

When in doubt, ask. Our community members are the experts on their own needs and are usually happy to guide you. An imperfect attempt at inclusion beats perfect exclusion every time.



10. Pre-event final preparations

The final countdown to excellence

You've planned meticulously for months. Now comes the critical phase where preparation transforms into performance.

The best events aren't those where nothing goes wrong - they're those where the team is so well-prepared that attendees never notice the inevitable hiccups. This section ensures you're ready for anything.

Navigate the Key Events Meeting (for Key Events only*)

If you have been identified as needing to attend the Key Events meeting, this probably means that the Campus Service teams are concerned about “getting it right” for your event and require further information from you to tackle any outstanding elements together. If you receive an invitation to the Key Events Meeting, the invitation is not optional, as it is vital that you attend.

What happens at the Key Events Meeting

If your event has been classified as a Key Event, you'll likely be invited to attend the Key Events Meeting three (3) weeks before your event

The setup

- Held every Thursday via Teams
- Chaired by the Duty Manager team
- Attended by representatives from Catering, AV, Security, Estates, and other Campus Services teams
- Typically lasts 1 hour

Your role

- Attendance is mandatory - Missing this meeting without prior arrangement could result in your event being cancelled
- Come prepared with your completed Event Information Sheet (EIS) - submitted at least one week before the Key Events Meeting via the [Event Information Sheet submission form](#)
- Be ready to answer questions about your requirements
- This is your chance to ask questions and clarify any uncertainties

How to make the most of it

- Make sure your EIS is up to date with the latest information
- Prepare specific questions for each Campus Services team as required
- Take notes on their recommendations
- Clarify who owns each action item

After the meeting

- Follow up on any outstanding items directly with the relevant team(s)
- Update your EIS if requirements change
- Stay in communication with your designated contacts

Remember: The teams at this meeting have supported hundreds of events. Their questions and suggestions come from experience - their aim is to help you succeed.





Develop your master checklist

Your final checklist isn't just a to-do list - it's your insurance policy against forgotten details. Build it collaboratively with your team to capture everything.

The anatomy of an effective checklist

Many event organisers have found it helpful to structure checklists by timeline rather than category:

- **One week before:** Final confirmations and documents
- **48-72 hours before:** Guest lists and supplier checks
- **Day before:** Rehearsals and setup
- **Event morning:** Final checks and briefings

This approach can help ensure nothing slips through the cracks.

Essential final week checklist

The following checklist has worked well for many events, though your specific needs may vary:

Seven days out

- ☐ Confirm all Campus Services teams have received final requirements
- ☐ Review running order with core team members
- ☐ Confirm speaker arrivals and technical needs
- ☐ Send final numbers to catering (5 working days minimum)
- ☐ Prepare name badges and registration materials
- ☐ Create emergency contact list
- ☐ Check weather forecast (if relevant)
- ☐ Print all your signage and materials

48-72 hours before

- ☐ Submit final guest list to Security
- ☐ Final headcount to all suppliers
- ☐ Confirm all deliveries scheduled
- ☐ Send final briefing to staff/volunteers
- ☐ Pack event supplies and materials
- ☐ Charge all devices and pack chargers
- ☐ Final registration check - manage waitlist

Day before

- ☐ Technical rehearsal with speakers (if applicable)
- ☐ Venue walk-through with Duty Manager
- ☐ Set up what you can in advance
- ☐ Creating a Teams group for convenient chat
- ☐ Brief Welcome Desk team
- ☐ Test all technology
- ☐ Check weather (final outdoor contingency decision)
- ☐ Confirm tomorrow's arrival times with everyone

Event morning

- ☐ Arrive 90+ minutes early (earlier for complex events)
- ☐ Team briefing huddle
- ☐ Final room setup check
- ☐ Test all AV one more time
- ☐ Confirm catering is on track
- ☐ Place your signage
- ☐ Registration desk ready
- ☐ Emergency procedures reminder



Master rehearsals and technical checks

Practice doesn't make perfect - it reveals what needs perfecting. Technical rehearsals are valuable investments in success.

Please note, if rehearsals and technical checks are required, these should be included in your original space request.

Technical rehearsal timeline

These timelines have proven effective for many events:

For most events (basic AV setup)

- Many organisers find it helpful to test everything 1 hour before the start
- Click through all presentations
- Check microphone levels
- Confirm WiFi works
- Test any video content

For more complex events (streaming, multi-camera, production)

- Consider a full technical rehearsal the day before
- Run a version of the show cue-to-cue
- Test all speaker presentations
- Check streaming connections
- Practice camera switches
- Confirm recording setup

Rehearsal checklist

Experienced event organisers have used this checklist to support them with running technical rehearsals:

Content checks

- ☐ All presentations are loaded and displaying correctly
- ☐ Videos play with sound at the right levels
- ☐ Animations and transitions work
- ☐ Backup copies on USB drives
- ☐ Comfort monitors showing presenter view

Audio checks

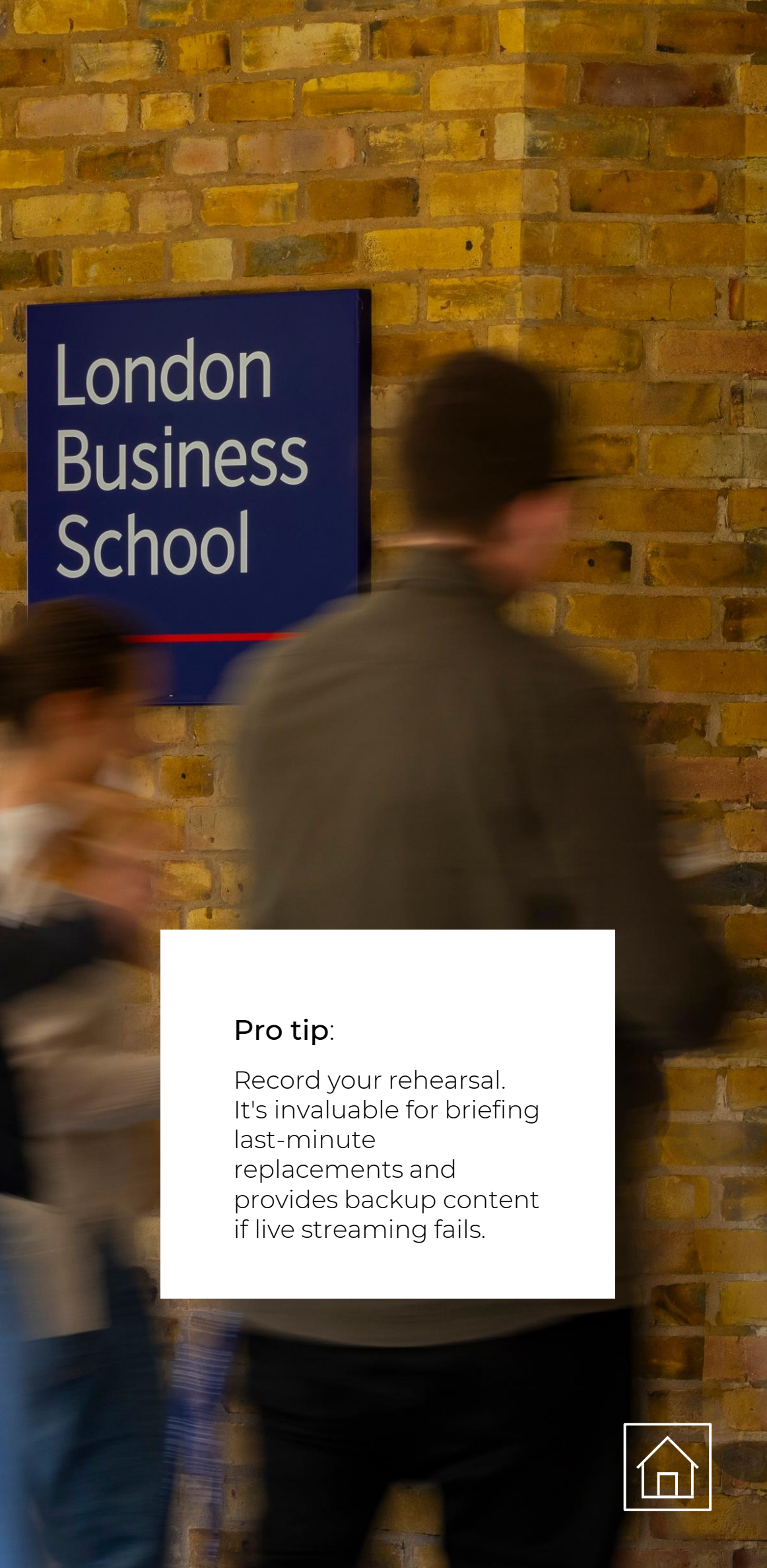
- ☐ Microphone levels for each speaker
- ☐ Feedback zones identified
- ☐ Backup microphones ready
- ☐ Hearing loop activated
- ☐ Background music tested

Visual checks

- ☐ Sightlines from all seats
- ☐ Lighting on speakers' faces
- ☐ No glare on screens
- ☐ Branding is visible in camera shots
- ☐ Recording framing confirmed

Speaker preparation

- ☐ Show speakers the stage setup
- ☐ Practice walking routes
- ☐ Test clicker/confidence monitors
- ☐ Review timing signals
- ☐ Confirm water placement



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Pro tip:

Record your rehearsal. It's invaluable for briefing last-minute replacements and provides backup content if live streaming fails.



Brief your team for success

Your staff and volunteers are the face of your event. Investing time in preparing them properly can make a significant difference - confused volunteers often create confused attendees.

A two-tier briefing approach

Many successful events use this structure:

Written brief (1-2 weeks before)

Consider including:

- Event vision and objectives
- Full programme with timings
- Venue layout and key locations
- Speaker photos and bios
- Guest WiFi details
- Communication methods (for example, WhatsApp groups)
- Role-specific responsibilities
- FAQs with approved answers
- Emergency procedures
- Dress code

Verbal briefing (day before or morning of)

Some organisers find it valuable to bring everyone together to:

- Walk through the venue
- Review key responsibilities
- Practice difficult scenarios
- Distribute contact lists
- Answer final questions
- Build team spirit

Communication protocols

Setting up channels

- Primary WhatsApp group (or alternative) for all staff
- Secondary group for core team only
- Test groups work on everyone's phones
- Share escalation protocols

Consider establishing clear language

Some teams use simple codes for efficiency:

- "Code Blue" for medical emergency
- "Code Red" for a security issue
- "All clear" when issues are resolved
- Keep your voice calm in all communications

Alternatively, plain language works well if everyone understands the protocols.

Useful contact numbers for campus events

- Duty Manager Sussex Place: 07966 907 265
- Duty Manager Sammy Ofer: 07976 806 120
- Security Control room: 02070 006 888
- Catering Duty Manager: 07966 907 871
- Porters: 07966 907 890 (this number is for 'out of hours' support only, available between 5pm- 7pm Monday to Friday and weekends between 7.30am- 4.30pm)



Perfect your signage and wayfinding

Good signage is invisible - people arrive where they need to be without thinking about it. Poor signage creates confusion cascades that ripple through your entire event.

Strategic signage placement

Consider signage for these areas:

External approach

- Building entrance identification
- Accessible entrance markers
- Parking directions
- Welcome messaging

Internal navigation

- Registration arrows from the entrance
- Breakout room identification
- Cloakroom signage
- Emergency exit markers
- Quiet space indicators

Event-specific signage

- Session room names
- Speaker changes notifications
- Networking space labels
- Refreshment locations
- WiFi passwords
- Photography notices

Campus signage logistics

Available resources

- A4 landscape holders (fixed to walls)
- A3/A4 free-standing holders
- Registration desk branding panels
- Digital screens (selected locations)

The typical process

- Create signs by following the [LBS Brand Guidelines \(in Brand Hub\)](#) in A4
- Request physical freestanding A4 sign stands by emailing the Porters - estates@london.edu
- As an Event Organiser, you are required to print and display your own signage

Design tips that work well

- High contrast for visibility
- Minimum 48pt font for directions
- Consistent design language
- Include accessibility symbols
- Test readability from 3 metres



Prepare for emergencies

Hope for the best, plan for the worst. Your ability to handle emergencies calmly determines whether they become minor hiccups or major disasters.

Know your escalation routes

These procedures align with LBS protocols:

Medical emergencies

1. Don't move the person unless in immediate danger
2. Call Security on 07966 907 888
3. Follow their instructions for emergency services
4. Clear space for paramedics
5. Have someone meet the ambulance at the entrance
6. Document the incident afterwards

Security incidents

1. Avoid confronting individuals directly
2. Contact Security immediately
3. Move other attendees away calmly
4. Follow the Security team's instructions
5. Preserve any evidence
6. Brief PR team if needed

Fire alarms

1. Stop the event immediately
2. Direct everyone to the nearest exit
3. Move to the assembly point
4. Check that accessibility needs are supported
5. Account for all team members
6. Only re-enter when cleared by Security

Technical failures

1. Some approaches that have worked well:
2. Have the presenter continue without slides if possible
3. Switch to backup equipment
4. Use paper handouts if available
5. Consider a break while fixing
6. Communicate honestly with the audience
7. Document for insurance if needed

Crisis communication protocols

Some teams have found these approaches effective:

Internal first

1. Alert Duty Manager immediately
2. Brief the core team via WhatsApp (or alternative)
3. Consider assigning specific response roles
4. Keep communication channels clear

External when needed

1. Many events designate a single spokesperson
2. Coordinate with the PR team if available
3. Consider preparing a holding statement
4. Monitor social media if relevant
5. Follow up with affected attendees



Create weather contingency plans

British weather doesn't respect your event schedule. If any element involves the outdoors, you need a Plan B that's as good as Plan A.

Weather decision timeline

Many outdoor events have successfully used this timeline for weather decisions:

One week out

- Start monitoring forecasts
- Review contingency options
- Alert suppliers to potential changes
- Prepare indoor backup spaces

48 hours before

- Make a preliminary decision
- Alert all stakeholders
- Adjust setup plans
- Update signage if needed

Day before (final call)

- Give yourself a firm deadline, ideally in the morning
- Communicate to all teams
- Adjust catering locations
- Update attendee communications
- Brief staff on changes

Contingency essentials

For outdoor receptions

- Pre-book an indoor alternative
- Have both setup plans ready
- Ensure catering works in both
- Test indoor acoustics
- Check capacity limits
- Prepare different signage

For outdoor team building

- Design indoor alternatives
- Book backup spaces
- Adapt activities for indoors
- Communicate dress code changes
- Adjust timing if needed

Partial solutions

- Marquee or tent options
- Heated outdoor spaces
- Umbrellas for transitions
- Indoor/outdoor hybrid
- Shortened outdoor segments

Pro tip: Present weather contingencies positively. "We've moved inside to our beautiful Dining Room", beats "Unfortunately, due to rain..."



Send final confirmations

Clear, comprehensive final communications prevent day-of confusion. Your attendees should arrive knowing exactly what to expect.

The 48-hour attendee email

Many organisers include these elements:

Essential information

- A reminder of why they should attend this event (until people are in the venue, they are not an attendee),
 - Share social proof from past attendees (e.g. testimonials)
 - Lead with compelling hooks that speak to the recipient
 - Use FOMO tactics so people know what they will miss out on by not attending
- Event timing and location
- Transport and parking options
- What to bring (ID for security)
- Dress code reminder
- Dietary arrangements confirmed
- WiFi access details
- Contact number for queries

Helpful additions to consider

- Weather forecast and advice
- Link to venue accessibility guide
- Agenda with session locations
- Speaker highlights
- Networking app instructions
- Social media hashtags

Clear calls to action

- Arrive from [time] for registration
- Bring business cards for networking
- Download the event app in advance (if applicable)
- Review pre-reads if provided
- Contact us with any concerns

Supplier confirmations

Consider including in every confirmation:

- Delivery/arrival time
- Contact person on-site
- Access instructions
- Parking arrangements
- Setup location
- Event timeline
- Payment status
- Your mobile number

You should get confirmation of

- Receipt of final numbers
- Understanding of requirements
- Arrival time commitment
- Equipment being brought
- Staffing levels
- Contingency plans



Your final 24-hour schedule

Here's a template that many event organisers have adapted successfully for their needs:

Day before (example timings)

- Venue access, begin setup
- Place signage
- AV setup begins
- Technical rehearsal
- Team briefing
- Final walk-through
- Secure venue, team rest

Event day (adjust timings to your event)

- [Event time minus 2 hours] - Team arrival
- [Minus 90 minutes] - Supplier setup
- [Minus 60 minutes] - Final tech check
- [Minus 45 minutes] - Team briefing
- [Minus 30 minutes] - Registration desk live
- [Minus 15 minutes] - Welcome team in position
- [Minus 5 minutes] - Final checks complete
- [Event time] - Doors open

The event organiser's personal checklist

Some organisers find it helpful to have a personal checklist for the day before:

- ☐ Phone charged, charger packed
- ☐ Run of show printed (multiple copies)
- ☐ Emergency contacts in phone AND on paper
- ☐ Backup of all presentations on USB
- ☐ Name badge and business cards
- ☐ Emergency cash for contingencies
- ☐ Basic first aid supplies
- ☐ Phone numbers for all speakers
- ☐ Spare copies of key materials
- ☐ Positive attitude and energy!

Preparation breeds confidence

The work you do in these final days determines your stress level on event day. Every rehearsal, every briefing, every contingency plan buys you the capacity to handle the unexpected with grace.

Your attendees won't see your checklists or know about your contingency plans. They'll simply experience an event that flows beautifully, where problems are solved before they notice them, where every detail feels considered.

That's the magic of thorough preparation - it becomes invisible excellence.

Next step: With everything prepared and ready, it's time for the main event. The next section guides you through delivering your event with confidence and managing the day itself.



11. On-the-day management

From planning to performance

The day has arrived. Your months of preparation now transform into hours of execution. This is where your role shifts from planner to conductor - orchestrating multiple moving parts while maintaining the calm confidence that keeps everyone performing at their best.

Successful day-of management isn't about preventing problems - it's about solving them so smoothly that your attendees never know they existed.

Deploy and manage your team effectively

When properly directed, your volunteers and staff become your greatest asset. Without clear leadership, even the most willing helpers become confused bystanders.

The morning huddle

You've already briefed everyone (covered in the previous section). Now's the time for a focused 5-minute stand-up to:

- Confirm everyone knows their first position
- Check that everyone has the WhatsApp groups (or alternative) working
- Distribute any last-minute changes
- Build energy and team spirit
- Remind about lunch/break arrangements

Dynamic deployment throughout the day

Your staffing needs shift as your event flows. Many experienced organisers use this approach:

Registration rush (first 30-45 minutes)

- Maximum bodies at the registration desk
- Overflow staff managing queues
- Dedicated VIP/speaker greeters
- Cloakroom fully staffed

Session time

- Skeleton crew at registration
- Microphone runners in position
- Ushers at the session room doors
- Standby team for issues

Break periods

- Registration restaffed for queries
- Ushers become crowd flow managers
- Extra support at refreshment areas
- Team preparing the next session room



Managing volunteer energy

The 2-hour rotation principle

Many events successfully rotate volunteers every 2 hours to maintain energy:

- Registration desk staff swap with ushers
- Morning team takes an extended lunch
- Fresh faces for afternoon sessions
- Key roles stay consistent throughout

Looking after your people

- Provide a dedicated volunteer break space
- Ensure everyone gets at least 30 minutes break
- Have water constantly available
- Feed them properly - not just leftover sandwiches
- Check in personally every hour
- Say "thank you" repeatedly and genuinely

Real-time role flexibility

Be prepared to redeploy instantly.

Signs someone needs reassigning:

- Overwhelm at registration
- Getting frustrated with attendees
- Energy levels low

Quick reassignment options:

- Move overwhelmed registrars to badge printing
- Shift quiet volunteers to signage checking
- Deploy frustrated staff to back-office tasks
- Give low energy team members seated roles



Master the registration flow

Registration sets the tone for your entire event. A smooth check-in creates confidence, whilst chaos creates anxiety that lingers all day.

The psychology of queue management

Make waiting feel shorter:

- Acknowledge people immediately - eye contact and smile
- Have overflow staff working the queue with iPads or a smartphone
- Provide clear signage about what attendees need ready
- Display programme highlights that they can read while waiting
- Keep the desk clear of clutter and confusion

Registration desk dynamics

Optimal setup for different attendance levels:

Up to 100 attendees	100-200 attendees	200+ attendees
• 2 registration staff • Single alphabet line • 1 troubleshooter for problems	• 4 registration staff • A-L and M-Z split • 2 troubleshooters • Separate the new registration point	• 6+ registration staff • A-G, H-P, Q-Z split • Dedicated VIP/speaker desk • Multiple troubleshooters • Consider a 'pre-print and collect' system

Managing registration challenges in real-time

Registration is expected for all big events and events with external guests. Here is some advice how to handle situations that could arise.

The missing badge

- Don't make them wait in the queue again
- Take them aside immediately
- Print a new badge while they get coffee
- Apologise once, then move on

The unexpected VIP

- Discreetly alert the core team via WhatsApp (or alternative)
- Fast-track through a separate channel
- Brief speaker liaison immediately
- Ensure catering knows about dietary requirements
- Update the security team

The oversubscribed session

- Have backup overflow space identified
- Set up a live stream if possible
- Offer priority for the next session
- Turn negative into positive with a special perk

The disputed payment

- Never argue at the desk
- Move to private space
- "Let's sort this after the session"
- Focus on experience, not transaction



Keep your event on time

Time slippage is contagious. Five minutes late in session one becomes fifteen minutes by lunch. Here's how to maintain discipline without being dictatorial.

Active timekeeping strategies

The countdown system that works

Instead of just showing timecards, many events use this escalating approach:

- **10 minutes:** Gentle reminder to speaker
- **5 minutes:** Visual signal + prepare to wrap
- **2 minutes:** Stand up at the side of the stage
- **0 minutes:** Walk onto the stage if needed
- **Overrun:** Interrupt politely but firmly

Managing Q&A time effectively

- Pre-select the first questioner during the talk
- Have staff with mics already in position
- "Time for two quick questions"
- Cut off politely: "Hold that thought for the networking"
- Never let Q&A eat into breaks

The art of moving people

Getting attendees back from breaks:

5 minutes before	2 minutes before	Session time
• Announcement in the break area • Ushers start with gentle encouragement • "Session resuming in 5 minutes"	• Lights flash in the break area (if possible) • Ushers become more directive • Start closing the refreshment service	• Close doors (but keep one usher outside) • Begin regardless of numbers • Late arrivals enter quietly at the back

Managing speaker time live

When speakers run over:

- Make eye contact and tap the watch
- Stand up visibly
- Hold up the timecard directly (if you have one)
- Walk towards the stage slowly
- If necessary, interrupt: "Fascinating insights - let's continue this in the Q&A"

When panels drift:

- Brief moderator to be strict
- Pass notes with time remaining
- Have backup questions that can be cut
- Be ready to skip Q&A entirely
- Never blame the speakers publicly



Support speakers in the moment

Speakers remember how you treat them when things go wrong, not when everything runs perfectly.

Green room management

Creating the right environment:

- Quiet space away from attendee traffic:
- Comfortable seating and good lighting
- Full-length mirror for last-minute checks
- Refreshments without messy food
- Clear running order posted
- Have a dedicated staff member always present

Real-time speaker support:

- 15-minute warning for stage time
- Escort them to the stage (never let them walk alone)
- Confirm any last-minute changes
- Check the microphone before they go on
- Have water ready on stage
- Stand where they can see you

Managing speaker crises

The nervous speaker

- Reassure without patronising
- Review the first two minutes with them
- Remind them that the audience wants them to succeed
- Offer to introduce them more fully
- Have backup content ready

The missing speaker

- Don't panic publicly
- Call/text immediately
- Prepare the interviewer to extend the previous session
- Have backup content ready
- Brief moderator to fill if needed
- Shuffle running order if possible

The controversial moment

- Don't overreact in the moment
- Let the moderator handle initially
- Only intervene if becoming hostile
- Have security briefed, but invisible
- Address privately at break
- Document everything

Navigate real-time crisis handling

Quick reminder: Emergency procedures were covered in section 10 of the toolkit. Here's how to execute them while maintaining event flow.

The principle of contained response

When issues arise:

1. Contain the impact
2. Continue the event
3. Communicate carefully
4. Close the loop afterwards

Managing without stopping your event

Medical incident during session

- Ushers quietly clear the immediate area
- First aider responds appropriately
- Speaker continues if appropriate, especially as larger audiences often won't notice
- Move the session if necessary
- Brief speaker at break

Technical failure mid-presentation

- Speaker continues without slides
- AV team works behind the scenes
- Have printed backup slides ready
- Make light of it: "Back to basics!"
- Switch rooms only as a last resort



Maintain live communication flow

Your communication system is only as good as its weakest link. Here's how to keep information flowing when it matters most.

WhatsApp group management

Keep channels clear:

- Core team only for decisions
- All-staff for updates
- No social chat during the event
- Acknowledge messages with a 'like' (👍)
- Use "URGENT:" for priorities
- Post "All clear" when resolved

Information hierarchy:

Broadcast to all:

- Schedule changes
- Emergency situations
- Break time updates

Core team only:

- VIP movements
- Problems being solved
- Supplier issues

Direct message:

- Individual performance issues
- Sensitive situations
- Personal requests

The regular check-in rhythm

Many event managers find this schedule helpful:

Every 30 minutes:	Every hour
• Registration desk status • Session room check • Catering progress • Team welfare scan	• Numbers update • Programme status • Issue resolution review • Energy check



Troubleshoot common day-of issues

Here are solutions to the problems that catch many first-time organisers off guard:

The usual suspects and their fixes

"The room is too hot/cold"

- Investigate immediately (perception varies)
- Adjust if possible, or contact the Duty Manager
- Open doors during breaks
- Acknowledge to complainants
- Provide fans/water by contacting the Duty Manager

"I can't hear the speaker"

- Check if localised or widespread
- Adjust audio immediately
- Offer seats closer to the front
- Have AV boost volume
- Brief speaker to project more
- Consider a personal hearing loop

"The WiFi isn't working"

- Check if individual or widespread
- Share the password again clearly
- Have IT contact ready
- Offer an alternative connection
- Acknowledge the frustration
- Don't promise what you can't deliver

"I'm in the wrong session"

- Check their registration
- Accommodate if there's space
- Offer the next best alternative
- Note for future planning
- Never make them feel foolish
- Follow up personally later

"The coffee has run out"

- Signal catering immediately
- Communicate realistic timing
- Offer alternatives
- Apologise once, sincerely
- Make light of it if appropriate
- Over-order for next break

The decision matrix for problems

When issues arise, quickly assess:

- **Can it be fixed in 2 minutes?** → Fix it now
- **Will it affect the current session?** → Fix at break
- **Is it affecting multiple people?** → Escalate immediately
- **Is it a nice-to-have?** → Note for post-event
- **Is someone very upset?** → Handle personally



Your personal energy management

You set the emotional temperature for your entire event. Your team mirrors your energy, and attendees sense your confidence or stress.

Sustaining yourself through the day

Practical self-care:

- Eat breakfast (not just coffee)
- Keep a water bottle with you
- Take 2-minute breathing breaks
- Delegate before you're desperate
- Sit down when you can
- Keep phone charged

Mental state management:

- Remember, most problems are invisible to attendees
- Your calm creates team calm
- Smile - it actually helps
- Focus on what's working
- Save analysis for tomorrow
- Celebrate small wins publicly

The event day rhythm

Understanding the natural flow helps you anticipate needs:

- **Opening energy** → High excitement, some chaos
- **First session** → Settling, finding rhythm
- **Mid-morning** → Smooth running, confidence building
- **Lunch** → Renewed energy, social buzz
- **Afternoon lull** → Energy dip, need animation
- **Final push** → Renewed focus, end in sight
- **Close** → Celebration

Remember: Excellence is in recovery. The best event managers aren't those who prevent all problems - they're those who solve problems so elegantly that attendees never know they happened. Your ability to adapt, stay calm, and keep your team focused transforms potential disasters into minor adjustments.

Every decision doesn't have to be perfect. It just has to keep the event moving forward with grace.

Next step: The event's over, but your job isn't. The final section covers post-event activities that transform today's experience into tomorrow's success.



12. Post-event activities

Transform today's event into tomorrow's success

The last attendee has left, and the venue is cleared. It's tempting to close the book on your event right now. Don't. What you do in the next few days determines whether your event was a one-time experience or a catalyst for lasting impact.

Post-event activities aren't administrative chores - they're investments in relationships, reputation, and future excellence.



Express gratitude meaningfully

Thank you messages matter more than you might think. They strengthen relationships, build goodwill, and often determine whether people support your next event.

The 48-hour thank you rule

Gratitude has a half-life. Express it quickly while the positive feelings are fresh.

Your thank you priority list:

Within 24 hours:

- Speakers (personal email or handwritten note at the event itself)
- Major sponsors or donors
- VIP attendees who made a special effort
- Anyone who went above and beyond

Within 48 hours:

- All attendees (can be automated, but with personalisation like making sure you use the recipient's name)
- Volunteers and staff
- Campus Services teams and suppliers
- Internal stakeholders

Within one week:

- Broader supporter network
- Media contacts who covered the event
- Partners who promoted it
- Anyone who helped but couldn't attend

Crafting thank you messages that resonate

Here are some templated emails that you can customise:

For speakers:

Dear [Name],

Your insights on [specific topic] truly resonated with our audience. The question about [specific moment] sparked conversations that continued long into the networking session.

[Include specific feedback or quote from attendee if available]

We'd be delighted to share the recording/photos once ready. Please let us know if you'd like any specific clips for your own use.

Thank you for contributing to such a meaningful discussion.

Warm regards,

[Your name]

For volunteers and staff:

Note: Consider copying line managers when thanking staff, especially for exceptional contributions:

Dear [Name],

Your work on [specific task] was instrumental to our event's success. [Specific example of their impact].

Your professionalism and positive energy didn't go unnoticed - several attendees specifically mentioned how helpful you were.

Thank you for your dedication.

Best wishes,

For attendees:

Dear [Name],

Thank you for joining us at [event name]. Your participation made it a truly special gathering.

[One specific highlight or outcome]

[Include any promised resources or recordings]

We hope to see you at future events.

[Include link to any relevant future events or mailing lists]

Best wishes,

[Your name/team]"

The power of public recognition

Consider these approaches:

- Social media shout-outs with photos (with permission)
- Internal newsletter mentions
- Team channel celebrations
- Thank you slides at the next all-staff meeting



Collect feedback strategically

Feedback is only valuable if you collect it, analyse it, and act on it. Many events gather feedback, then never look at it again. Don't be one of them.

The multi-perspective approach

Different stakeholders see different things. Gather feedback from multiple viewpoints:

Attendee feedback

Common methods that yield good response rates:

Immediate collection (highest response rate):

- QR code on the final slide or on an iPad at the exit.
- Paper forms with an incentive
- "Complete before you leave" announcement

Follow-up surveys (lower response but more considered):

- Only do a post-event survey to attendees if you're going to do something with the data and insights. Otherwise, you are adding more demands on our community, which could lead to survey fatigue. If you decide to do a survey, we recommend sticking to the following:
- Send an email with the survey link within 24 hours
- Keep to 7 questions maximum
- Mix ratings with open text
- Indicate "2 minutes to complete"
- Consider incentives (prize draw, future discount)

Essential questions to include:

- Overall satisfaction (1-10 scale)
- Would you recommend it to a colleague? (Net Promoter Score)
- What was most valuable?
- What could be improved?
- Would you attend again?



Internal feedback mechanisms

Team debrief approaches that work:

The immediate reflection (same day):

- 15-minute standing huddle
- Capture immediate observations
- Note what needs urgent follow-up
- Celebrate the wins

The structured debrief (within one week):

- Schedule when booking the event
- Use a structured format (see below)
- Include all key stakeholders
- Document everything

The feedback log (ongoing): Create a shared document where team members can add observations as they remember them:



What worked well	What could improve	Quick wins for next time	Bigger changes to consider
E.g. Smooth registration flow	E.g. Lunch queue was too long	E.g. Order 20% more coffee	E.g. Consider a second lunch service point
E.g. Speaker transitions perfect	E.g. Signage unclear	E.g. Better directional arrows	E.g. Digital signage system



Analyse data and create meaningful reports

Raw data is just numbers. Analysis turns it into insight. Reporting turns insight into action.

Building your evaluation framework

Structure your analysis around your original KPIs:

Quantitative analysis:

- Attendance rate (registered vs attended)
- No-show percentage and patterns
- Demographic breakdown (if collected)
- Session attendance distribution
- Engagement metrics (questions asked, app interactions)
- Social media reach and engagement

Qualitative analysis:

- Sentiment themes from open feedback (where available)
- Unexpected outcomes or benefits
- Recurring improvement suggestions
- Stakeholder relationship changes
- Team performance observations

Creating reports that get read

Many evaluation reports gather dust, but as a School, we require some key information from you to help assess the impact of your event and use these findings to make improvements to how we all approach events. The event reporting form includes the following:

- Event name and brief description
- Logistical information, including date and venue
- Your event objective(s)
- Information on your attendees, such as targets, ticket sales, and turnout
- Details about any high-profile speakers or VIPs

The form will be emailed to you to complete after your event. If you run regular events, this form can be completed for all your events once per quarter. In addition, you may also want to create your own internal report that can be shared with colleagues or club members. Reports like this typically include:

Executive summary structure (one page):

- Event basics (date, attendance, budget)
- Achievement against KPIs
- Three key successes
- Three improvement areas
- Recommended actions
- ROI calculation (if relevant)

Detailed report sections (for those who need depth):

1. **Event overview:** Objectives, audience, programme
2. **Performance against KPIs:** Each metric with context
3. **Stakeholder feedback:** Summarised by group
4. **Financial summary:** Budget vs actual
5. **Content and communications:** Reach and engagement
6. **Operational review:** What worked, what didn't
7. **Recommendations:** Specific, actionable, prioritised
8. **Appendices:** Raw data, feedback verbatims



Return on investment calculations

When deciding whether to run this event or a similar one again in the future, it is important to consider both the financial and strategic benefits.

Financial ROI:

- Direct revenue (tickets, sponsorship)
- Pipeline generated (for business development events)
- Cost per attendee
- Cost per outcome (lead, application, donation)

Strategic ROI:

- Relationships strengthened
- Brand awareness increased
- Knowledge transferred
- Community built
- Reputation enhanced

This information will help you inform future event decisions.

Share content thoughtfully

Your event generated content. Now multiply its value through strategic sharing.

Content audit and preparation

Inventory what you have:

- Recordings (sessions, interviews)
- Photography
- Presentation slides
- Social media content
- Attendee testimonials
- Key quotes or insights

Prepare for distribution:

- Edit recordings for highlights
- Get final permissions for sharing
- Add captions to videos
- Create quote graphics
- Write summary articles

Distribution strategy

Immediate sharing (within 48 hours):

- Thank you message with key photos
- Social media highlights - remember to use the hashtag #WhyILoveLBS
- Quick wins or announcements
- Promised resources

Short-term sharing (within 2 weeks):

- Full recording access (if applicable)
- Photo galleries
- Summary blog post
- Presentation decks
- Follow-up resources

Long-term value (ongoing):

- Case studies
- Marketing materials for the next event
- Annual report content
- Website updates

Managing permissions and IP

Remember to:

- Check speaker agreements for recording rights
- Respect photography opt-outs
- Credit content creators
- Protect confidential information
- Archive securely with access controls



Reconcile budgets properly

When planning your event, you had a budget. Financial reconciliation will help you understand true costs and value.

The complete reconciliation process

Within one week:

- Collect all outstanding invoices
- Confirm all supplier charges
- Document any damages or penalties
- Calculate final attendance income
- Note any sponsor payments due

Within two weeks:

- Complete expense claims
- Reconcile credit card purchases
- Update budget tracker
- Flag any disputes
- Calculate final position

Within one month:

- Provide final budget report
- Process all payments
- Close purchase orders
- Archive financial records
- Document cost per outcome

Budget variance analysis

Understanding why helps future planning:

Common variance causes:

- Attendance is different from the projection
- Last-minute requirements
- Supplier price changes
- Forgotten cost elements
- Exchange rate fluctuations
- Emergency purchases

Document for next time:

- Actual vs budgeted by line item
- Percentage variance
- Explanation for major differences
- Recommendations for future budgets
- Hidden costs discovered



Evaluate against your KPIs

You set SMART objectives at the start. Now measure honestly.

The honest assessment

For each KPI, document:

- Target vs actual
- Data source
- Confidence level
- Contributing factors
- Lessons learned

Example evaluation:

KPI: Achieve 75% attendance rate

- Target: 75%
- Actual: 68%
- Data: Registration system
- Confidence: High
- Factors: Transport strike, competing event announced late
- Learning: Build in a larger buffer, check the calendar more thoroughly

Beyond the numbers

Some outcomes aren't captured in KPIs:

- Unexpected partnerships formed
- Innovative ideas generated
- Team capabilities developed
- Process improvements identified
- Relationship quality changes
- Reputation impacts

Document these too - they often matter more than metrics.

Transfer knowledge for future success

Your learning shouldn't leave with you. Create a legacy that makes the next event better.

The comprehensive handover package

For recurring events, document:

- Event factsheet (the complete guide):
- Vision and strategic purpose
- Historical attendance and budgets
- Stakeholder map with contact details
- Supplier evaluations and contracts
- Venue assessments and layouts
- Speaker database with notes
- Sponsor information and packages
- Marketing channels and performance

Process documentation:

- Timeline with realistic durations
- Checklists that actually work
- Template documents
- Brand assets and guidelines
- Registration platform setup
- Communication templates
- Risk register and mitigations

Relationship intelligence:

- Who really makes decisions
- Unwritten rules and preferences
- Political sensitivities
- Champions and challengers
- Historical context for the current state

The honest debrief:

- What we'd do differently
- What we'd definitely repeat
- Hidden challenges to expect
- Quick wins available
- Resources needed vs available
- Team structure recommendations



Student club succession planning

For student-run events, continuity is crucial:

Create your legacy file:

- Strategic planning documents
- Contact databases (GDPR compliant)
- Sponsor relationships and history
- Successful event formats
- Failed experiments and why
- Financial records and budgets
- Partnership agreements
- Brand assets and templates

Handover meeting essentials:

- Schedule before successors get busy
- Walk through one event cycle
- Share unwritten knowledge
- Introduce to key contacts
- Provide passwords and access
- Offer ongoing mentorship

Future-proofing tips:

- If the event was a Key Event and a success, book next year's date as early as possible
- Maintain supplier relationships
- Keep sponsor contacts warm
- Document everything in shared drives
- Create institutional memory
- Build sustainable processes



The continuous improvement mindset

Every event is a learning opportunity. The best event organisers aren't those who run perfect events - they're those who make each event better than the last.

Action planning from evaluation

Transform feedback into action:

- Quick wins (implement immediately):
- Simple process improvements
- Small budget adjustments
- Easy logistics changes
- Communication tweaks

Medium-term improvements (next event):

- Supplier changes
- Format adjustments
- Team restructuring
- System upgrades

Strategic changes (long-term):

- Fundamental format shifts
- Audience redefinition
- Partnership restructuring
- Investment requirements

Closing the loop

- For everyone who provided feedback:
- Acknowledge receipt
- Share what you're changing
- Explain what you can't change and why
- Thank them for contributing
- Invite continued engagement

The value of closure

- Completing post-event activities properly does more than tie up loose ends. It:
- Strengthens relationships for future events
- Builds institutional knowledge
- Improves ROI through learning
- Protects reputation through follow-through
- Creates continuous improvement culture
- Transforms one-time events into ongoing value

Your event may be over, but its impact continues through the work you do now. Make it count.



Thank You

You did it

Thank you for taking the time to work through this toolkit. By reaching this point, you've equipped yourself with the knowledge to create memorable events that strengthen our community and advance our mission.

We've designed this toolkit to be comprehensive - covering everything from strategic planning to post-event learning. But we recognise that when you're in the midst of organising your event, you'll need quick access to specific information and practical tools. That's why we've created supporting resources, including templates, checklists, and quick reference guides that will be available when you need them. Our Campus Services teams are also ready to share their expertise and help you navigate any challenges that arise.

Whether this will be your first event at London Business School or you're building on previous experience to make your next one even better, you now have both the strategic framework and practical support to succeed. Every event is an opportunity to create something memorable - to spark connections, generate insights, and contribute to the vibrant intellectual life of our School.

Thank you for your commitment to excellence in event delivery. The time and care you invest in following these guidelines directly contribute to London Business School's reputation as a place where extraordinary things happen.

We look forward to supporting you as you bring your event to life.

London Business School